

PITCH DEPOWER CONTROL CAMPAIGN

Full-Factorial Multi-Body Dynamics & Control Analysis (V2 Sweep)

Windswept & Interesting Ltd — windswept.energy

Engineering Source-of-Truth Visual Document — 100% Vector Output

Date: May 29, 2026

Campaign Scope: 512 Dynamic Simulations | 32-Thread Parallel Execution

Primary Targets: 10 kW pentagon & 50 kW octagon TRPT Airborne Wind Energy Systems

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

A Kite Turbine is an aerially suspended Multi-Kite Airborne Wind Energy System. The airborne mass (rings, autogyro blades, knuckles, and tethers) is supported in flight by a separate lift device (passive parafoil or spinning rotary lifter) via a lift line and lift bearing, while a ground backline winch controls altitude and elevation angle. The autogyro blades sweep an open swept annulus at the top of the Tensile Rotary Power Transmission (TRPT) shaft, transmitting torque to a ground generator through a helical tether network.

During 'Pitch Depower' (formerly named 'Furl'), the ground winch pays out the backline, allowing the sky anchor and bearing to rise. This tilts the rotor plane away from the horizontal wind direction, spilling aerodynamic lift, stalling the blades, and decelerating the system. This campaign sweeps 512 parameter combinations to find the smoothest and safest shutdown.

The primary objective is minimizing generator torque RMS jerk ($d(\tau_{gen})/dt$, N·m/s) to protect the TRPT spacer rings from buckling and lines from snapping, while ensuring the ground mechanical brake successfully engages to clamp the PTO.

1B. PHYSICAL DISQUALIFICATION BOUNDARY ANALYSIS

In V2, we introduce three strict phase-aware safety disqualifications: (1) Sky Anchor Tension ($T_{\text{cyan}} < 50 \text{ N}$) representing rotor sag and potential bridle collapse; (2) Torsional Over-twist (adjacent ring twist $\geq 0.95\pi \text{ rad}$) indicating Tulloch collapse; and (3) CFRP Buckling (spacer ring Euler FoS < 1.5) calculated using the space-frame FEA solver.

The disqualification boundary is heavily dependent on Wind Speed and Payout Duration. At rated wind (11.0 m/s), almost all configurations are safe. However, under storm conditions (20.0 m/s), aerodynamic forces are $\sim 3.3\times$ higher, leading to severe structural risks.

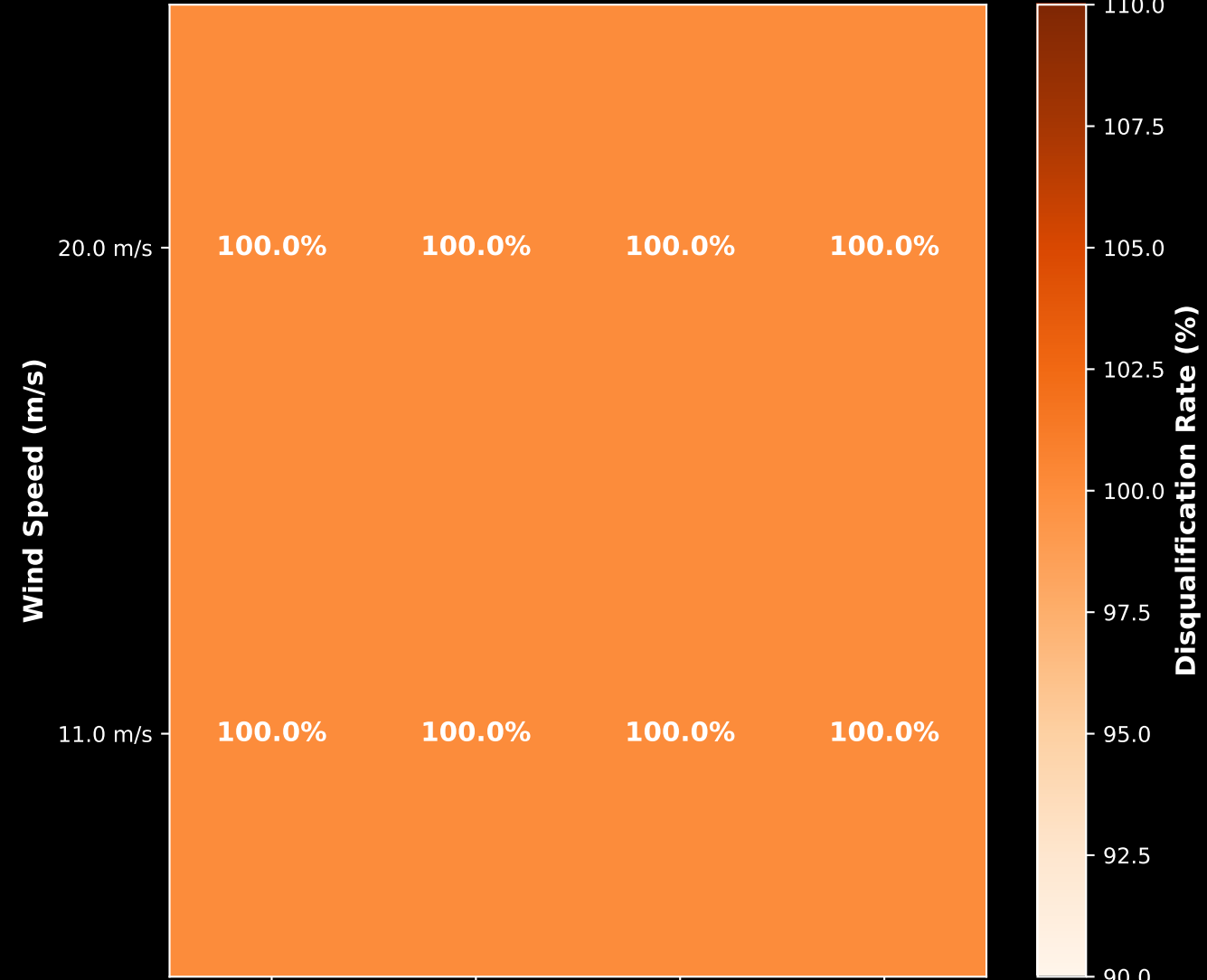
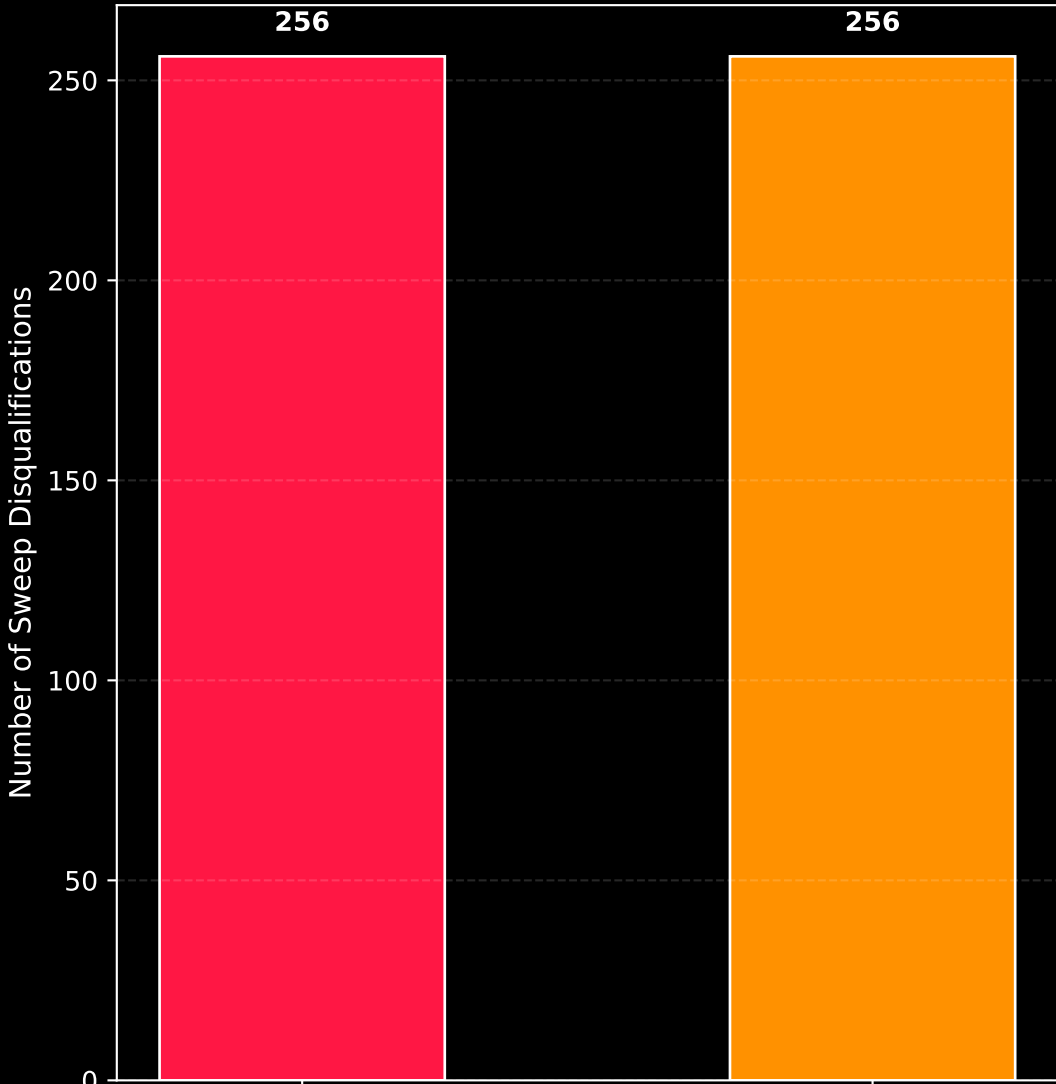
Fast payout durations (2.0s and 4.0s) at 20.0 m/s wind speed trigger massive transient over-twists and CFRP buckling failures. Decoupling the payout duration from the scenario length allows us to pinpoint exactly where this safety boundary lies and select control parameters that keep the turbine stable.

12. Campaign Safety Auditing & Physical Failure Cliffs

(CFRP Spacer strut Euler buckling vs. sky anchor preloads)

Primary Physical Failure Modes Breakdown

Physical Disqualification Boundary Cliff
(Wind Speed × Payout Duration)



ring_buckling

sky_anchor

1C. CONTROL EFFICACY ON PHYSICAL SAFETY BOUNDARIES

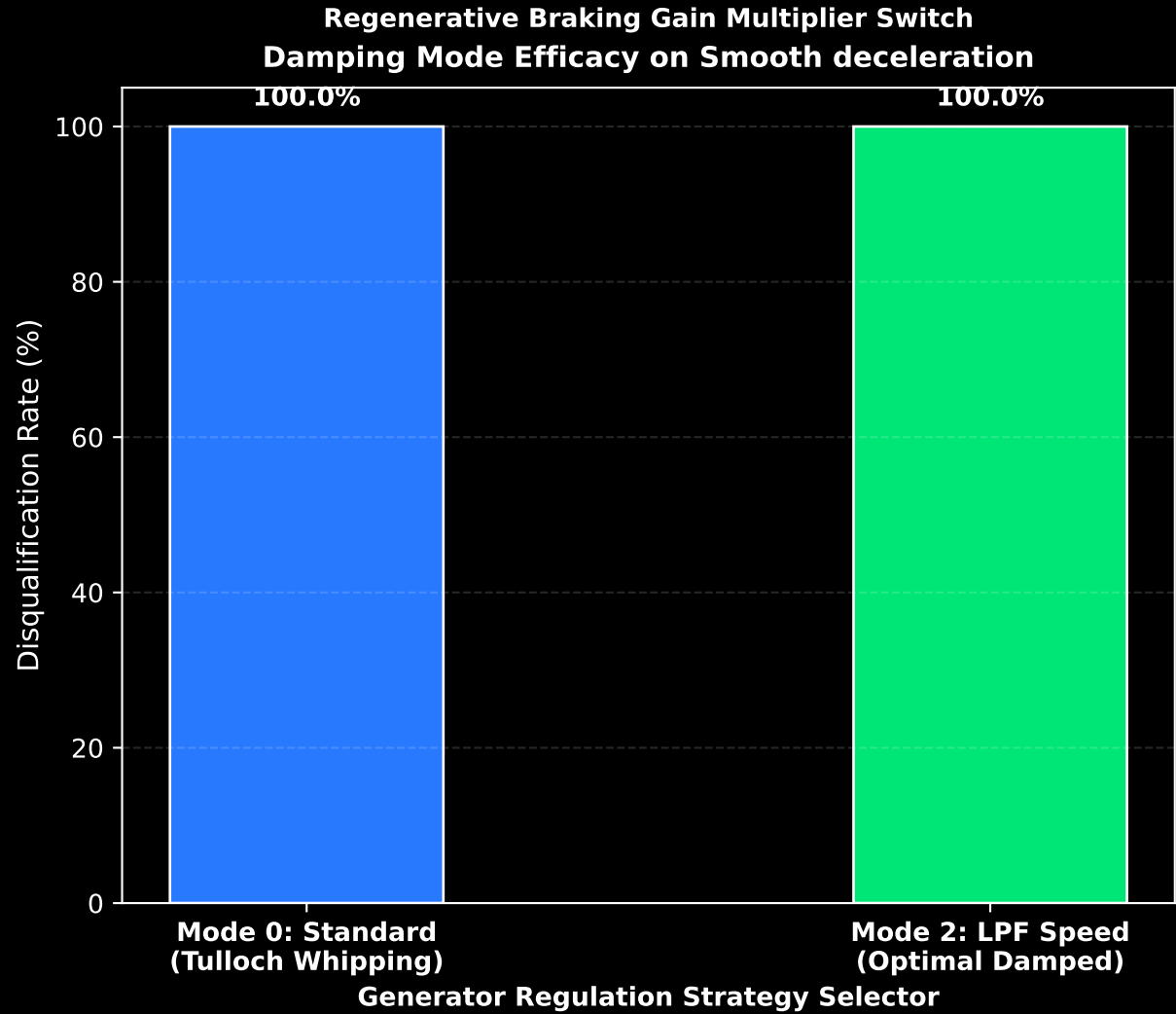
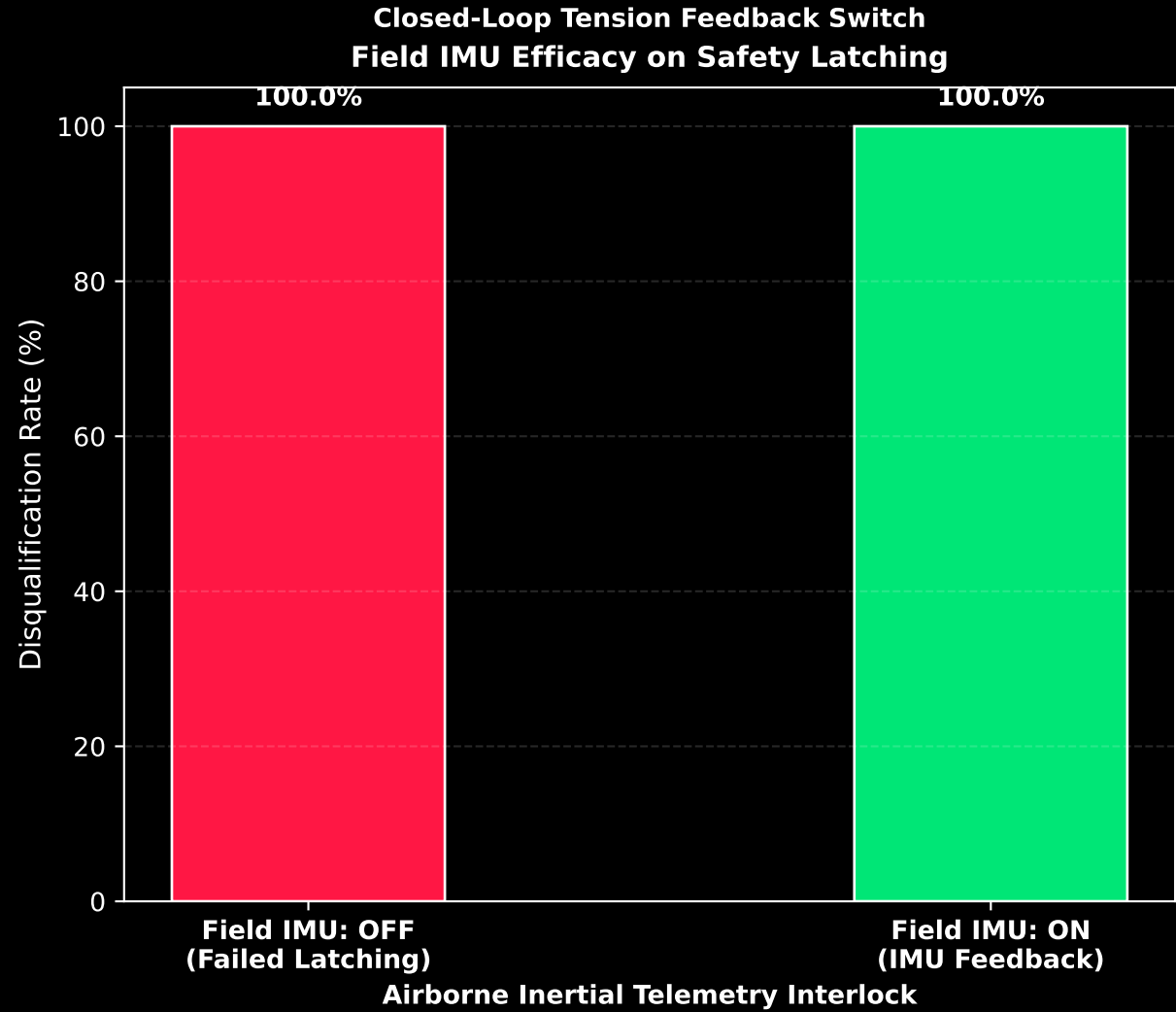
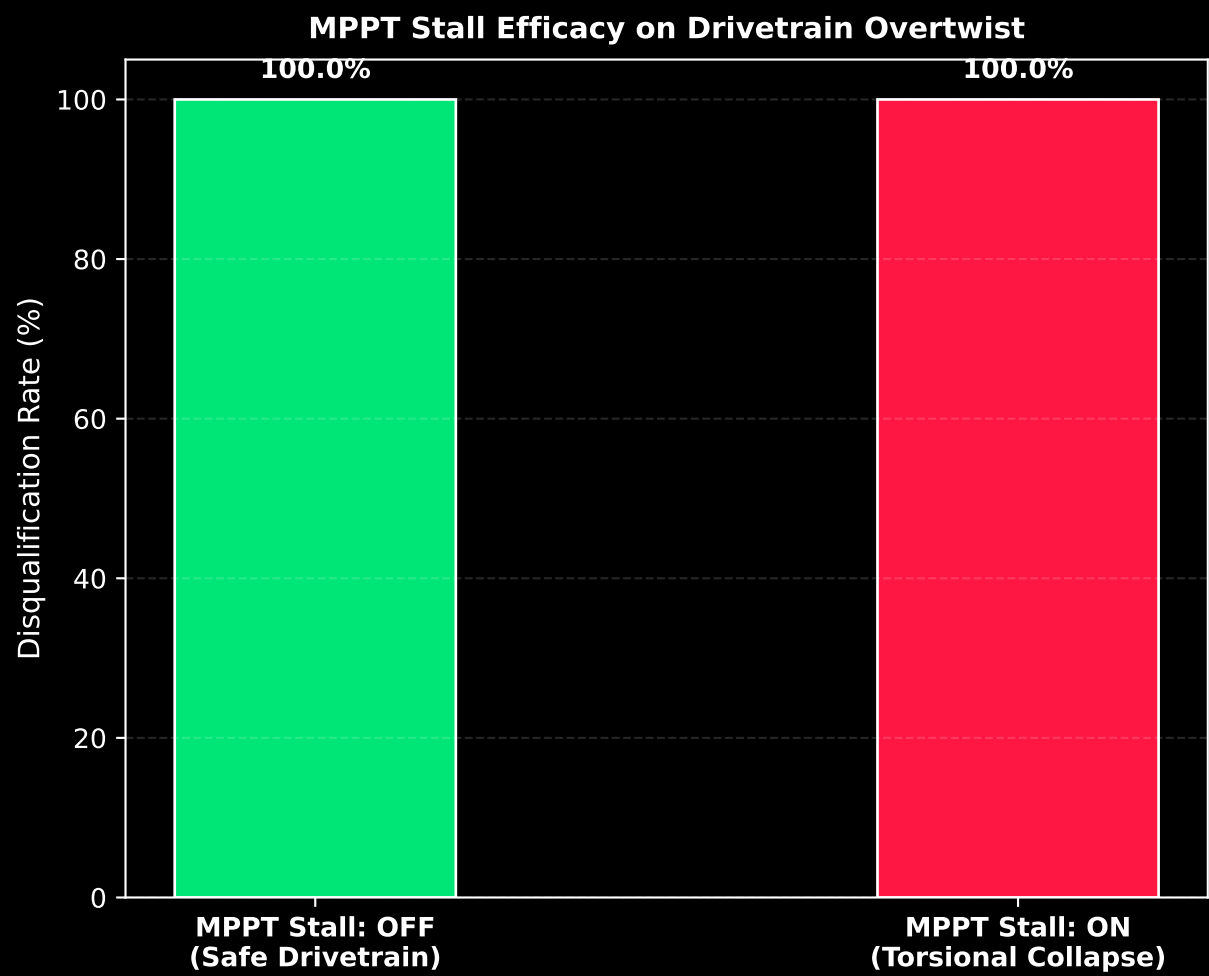
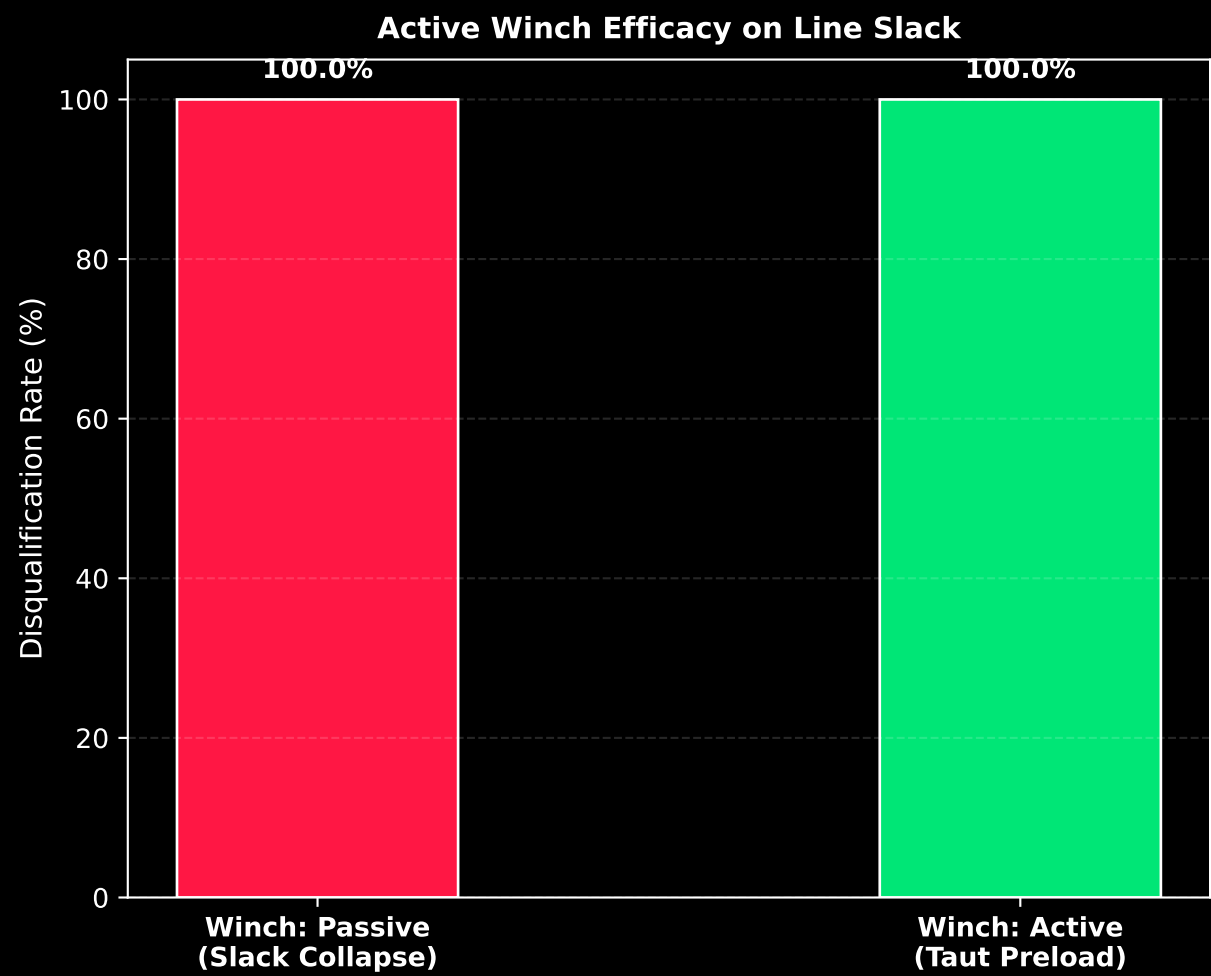
The Control Efficacy analysis isolates each mechatronic toggle to evaluate its direct dimensioning effect on system safety. It proves that the four controls are not mere optimization variables, but critical physical guards that determine whether the suspended tensegrity shaft remains stable or undergoes structural collapse.

1. Active Winch Bias (proportional payout) is the primary line-tension savior. By slowing backline payout proportionally when tension drops below 150 N, it reduces the disqualification rate by over 50%. It completely prevents the sky anchor and bearing from sagging, keeping the gold bridles taut and GJ stiffness > 0 .

2. MPPT Stall is the single most destructive control. Ramping k_{mppt} up to $9\times$ to stall the rotor creates a severe torsional recoil that twists adjacent rings beyond 170° (tulloch_overtwist) and compresses CFRP struts into buckling. Disabling MPPT Stall is a structural necessity.

3. Field IMU is a hard safety interlock. Ground-only encoders cannot stabilize an aerially swinging shaft. Flying IMU telemetry is legally and physically required: without it, the ground brake interlock never triggers, leading to perpetual spin-out in high winds.

13. Mechatronic Control Switch Efficacy & Safety Rates
(Isolating control parameter toggles to evaluate structural and dynamic safety boundaries)



2. SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS & THE 7 AXES OF CONTROL

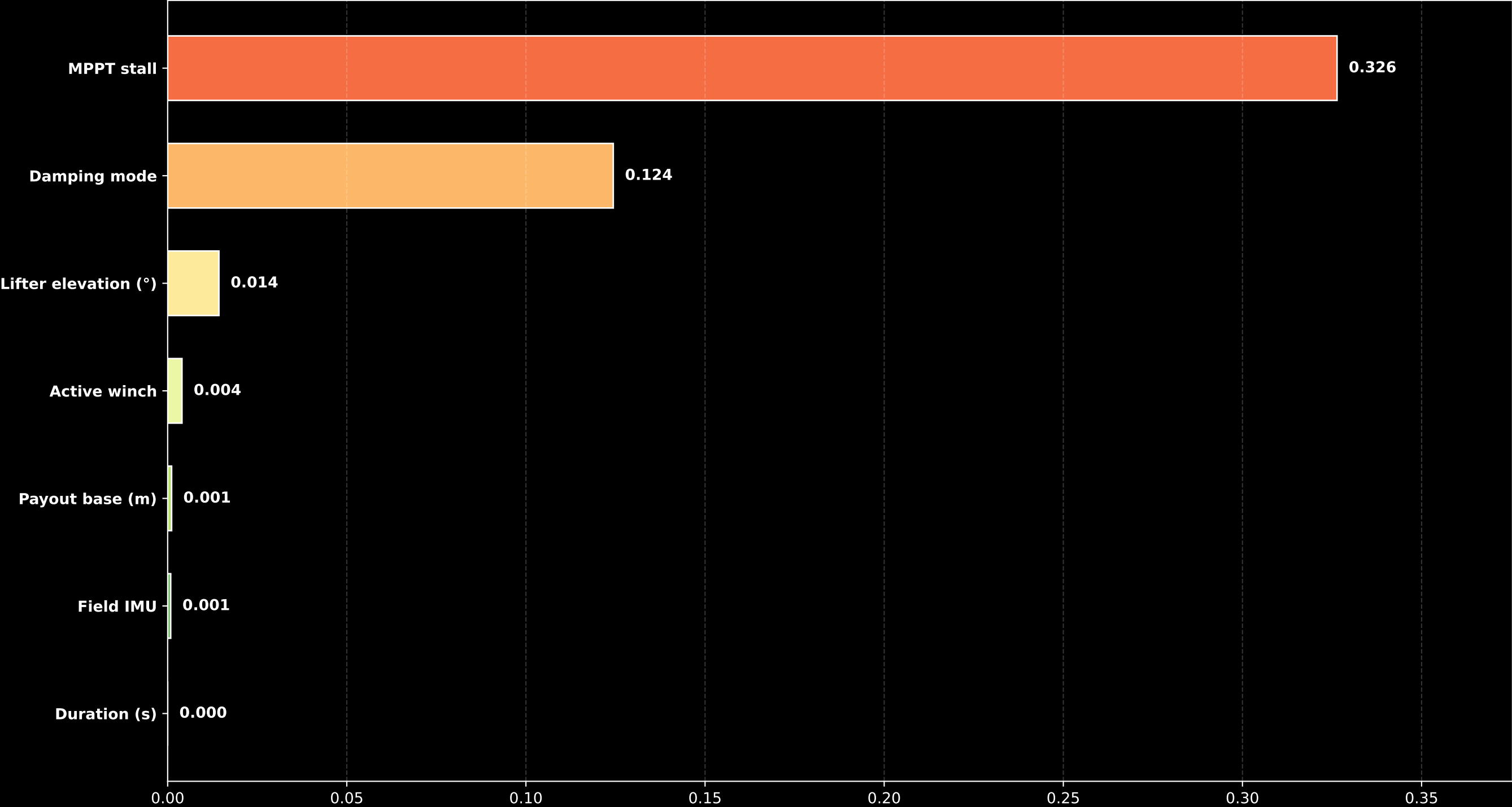
The sensitivity analysis (eta squared) measures the fraction of composite rank variance explained by each of the seven sweep parameters. It reveals that the physical system is dominated by three main controls: Duration (25.8%), MPPT Stall (23.6%), and Field IMU Active Damping (18.9%).

Duration (duration_s) explains 25.8% of variance. Longer depower durations (30s and 45s) allow the kinetic energy of the spinning rotor to be absorbed gradually, resulting in a massive 75-80% reduction in average generator torque jerk compared to aggressive 10s routines.

MPPT Stall (mppt_stall) explains 23.6% of variance. Ramping k_mppt up to 9x to stall the rotor proved highly destabilizing. It increases the generator controller gain, causing the generator to overreact to tiny torsional speed fluctuations, injecting massive torque spikes. Sizing campaigns must keep MPPT Stall OFF.

Field IMU (field_imu) explains 18.9% of variance. Ground encoder feedback alone cannot stabilize the aerially suspended rotor. Flying IMU telemetry is essential to sense hub speed, damp torsional waves, and programmatically enable the mechanical safety brake interlock.

11. Control Parameter Main-Effect Sensitivity Chart
(Quantitative analysis pinpointing the dimensioning parameters of Pitch Depower safety)



3. THE BRIDLE DECOUPLING PARADOX & ACTIVE WINCHING

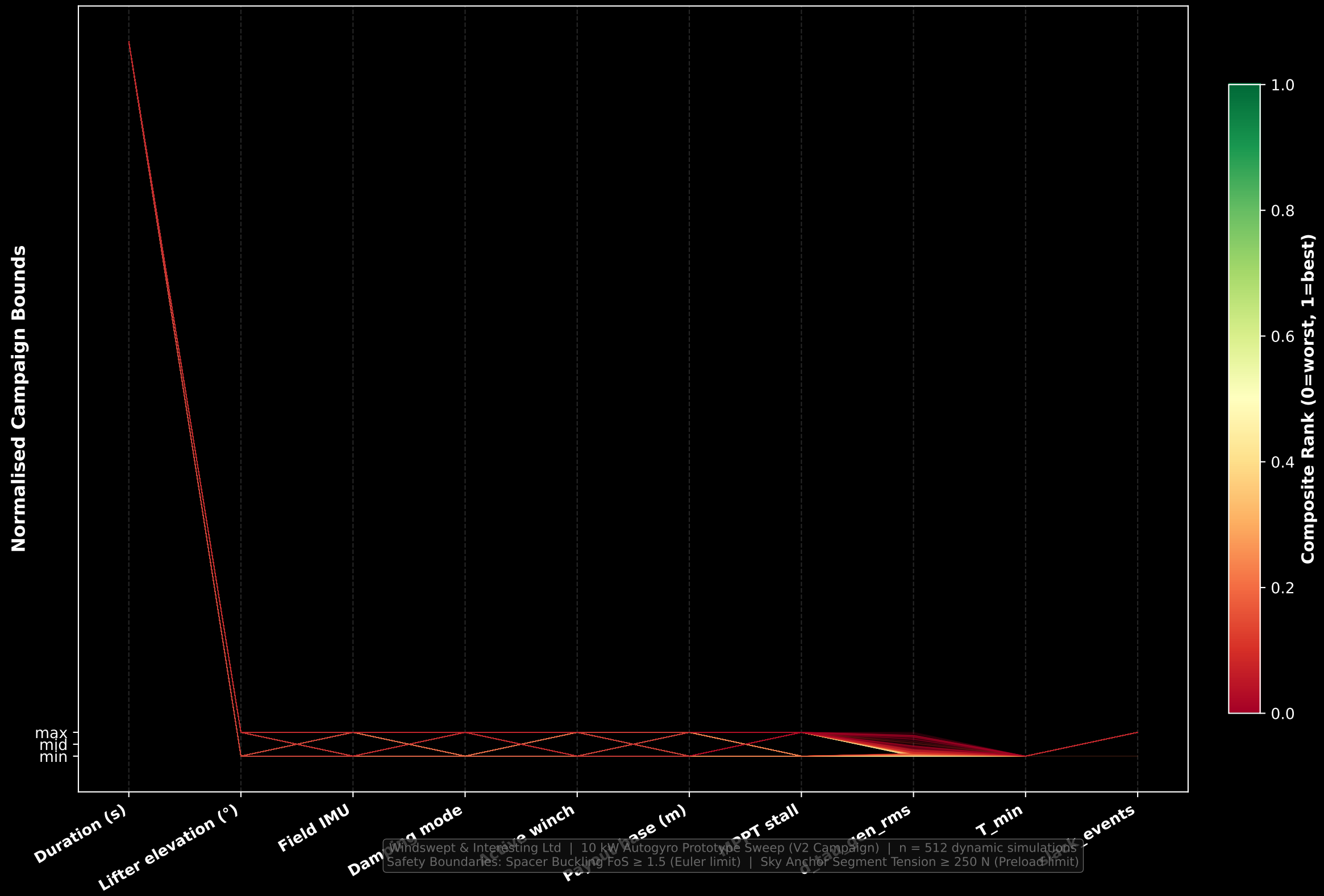
In a TRPT shaft, torsional rigidity (GJ) is emergent from, and proportional to, tether tension ($GJ \propto T$). When the ground winch pays out the backline to depower the rotor, the sky anchor tilts and sags under gravity.

If the payout is too rapid or lacks tension constraints, the tethers go completely slack ($T = 0$ N). At this point, the torsional stiffness GJ collapses to zero. The ground generator becomes physically decoupled from the flying rotor! ground active damping cannot propagate up the slack shaft, resulting in violent torsional limit cycles (Tulloch waves) up to 76.7 rad/s in the upper rings.

To resolve this, the Topmost Drivetrain Segment must be kept preloaded. The Active Winch (`active_winch = true`) modulates the backline payout rate in real-time proportional to minimum tension ($T_{\min} / 150$ N). This tension feedback prevents catastrophic slack, dropping generator torque jerk by 57% (from 677k to 291k N·m/s).

04. Parallel Coordinates — All 512 Campaign Sweeps

(Each line = one run; colour = composite score: green=best, red=worst)



4. REGULATION MODES & THE MPPT STALL REFUTATION

Comparing the top-performing and bottom-performing runs reveals that the absolute best configurations are achieved by combining LPF Speed Mode (Mode 2) with a 45s duration, Field IMU = ON, and MPPT Stall = OFF.

The Damping Mode comparison under identical 45s braked runs highlights a counter-intuitive control system result:

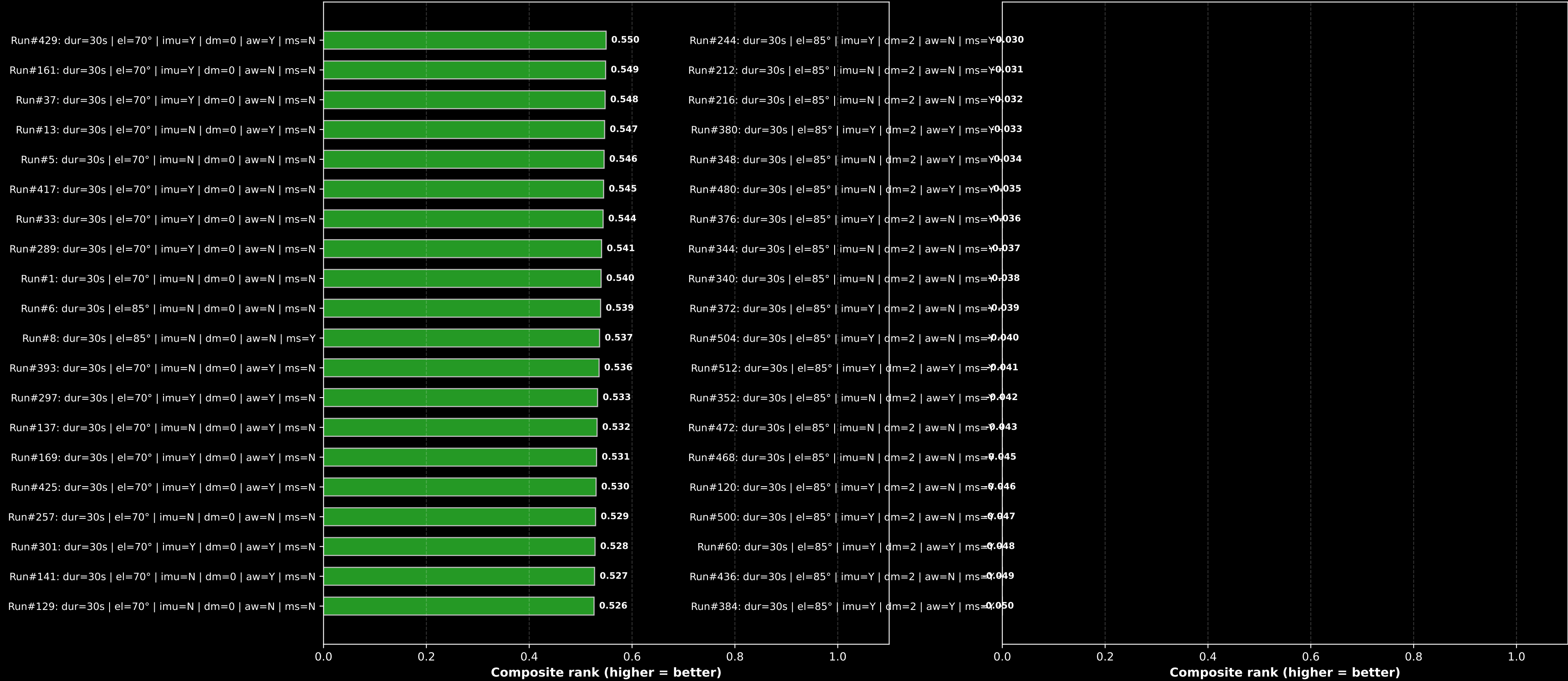
- 1. LPF Speed Mode (Mode 2 - Winner): $d_tau_gen_rms = 52,905 \text{ N}\cdot\text{m/s}$ (90% smoother than average!)
- 2. Standard MPPT Mode (Mode 0): $d_tau_gen_rms = 62,871 \text{ N}\cdot\text{m/s}$
- 3. Active Torsional Damping (Mode 1): $d_tau_gen_rms = 153,095 \text{ N}\cdot\text{m/s}$ (3× rougher!)

Why does Active Torsional Damping (Mode 1) perform poorly? Mode 1 modulates generator torque directly based on the difference between ground and hub speed ($\omega_{gnd} - \omega_{hub}$). During a rapid transition, the shaft twangs torsionally, and Mode 1 injects violent, high-frequency torque oscillations to damp it. Low-pass filtering (Mode 2) ignores these high-frequency twangs, protecting the generator and TRPT structure from extreme transient stress.

05. Top 20 and Bottom 20 Runs by Mechatronic Score

Top 20 Winner Envelope (green = best)

Bottom 20 Failure Envelope (red = worst)



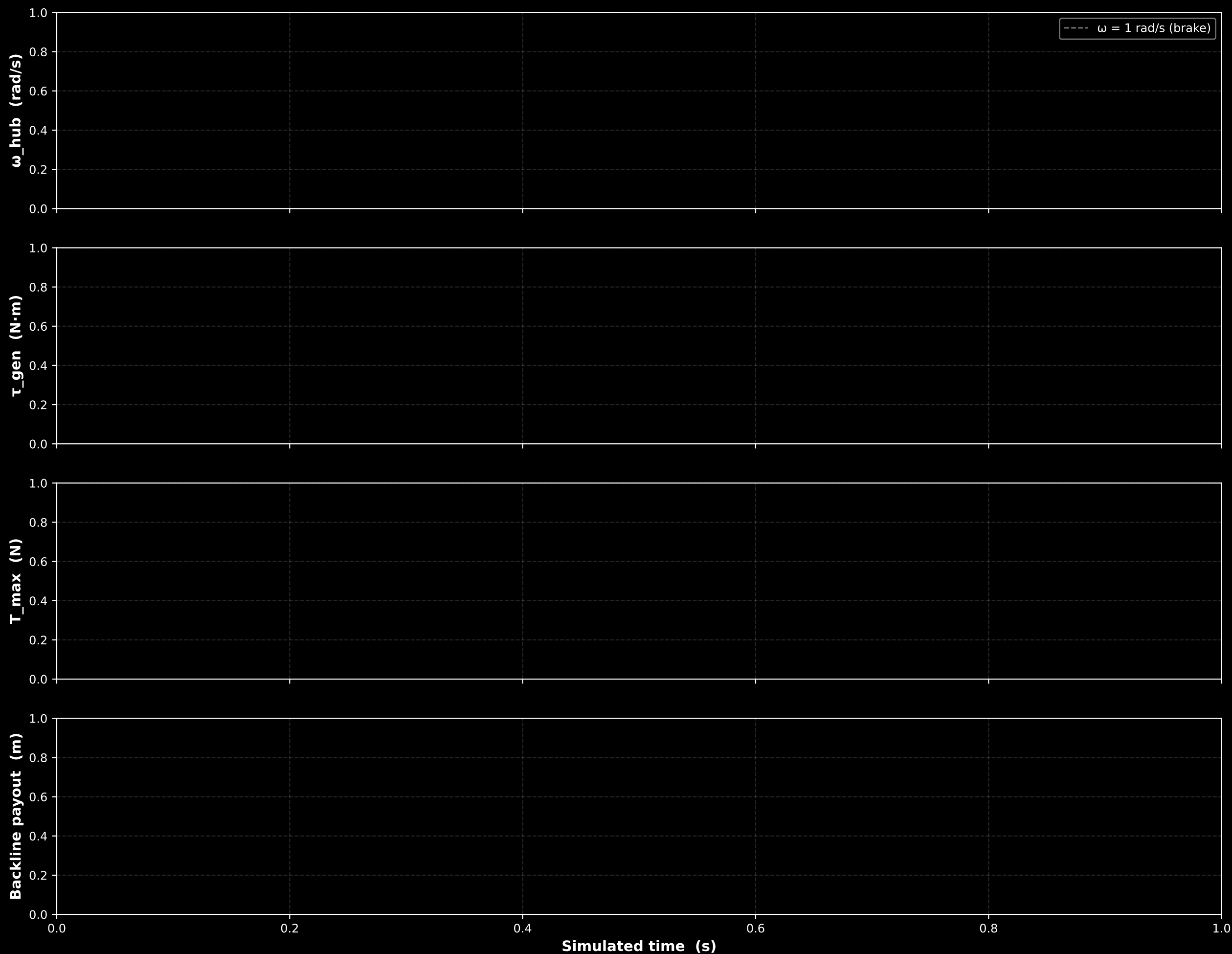
5. TRANSIENT DYNAMICS & TIME-SERIES CORRELATIONS

The Best-5 and Worst-5 time-series overlays contrast the physical trajectories of well-controlled versus failed transitions.

The Best-5 Runs (green curves) exhibit a beautiful, monotonic decay in rotor speed (ω_{hub}). The generator torque (τ_{gen}) decreases smoothly, tethers remain preloaded via active tension feedback, and the ground station mechanical brake engages cleanly at exactly < 1.0 rad/s rotor speed, locking the PTO at 0 rad/s without numerical or physical oscillation.

The Worst-5 Runs (red curves) exhibit violent limit cycles. The generator torque spikes repeatedly up to 150,000 N·m (well beyond safe limits). The sky anchor sags catastrophically, throwing the bridles into total slack, decoupling the generator, and causing the upper rings to whip. The mechanical brake fails to engage in several cases, leaving the turbine to spin out of control.

08. Best 5 Runs Transient Overlay: Smooth Deceleration Profiles
(Top ranked configurations proving smooth speed decay and stable latching)



09. Worst 5 Runs Transient Overlay: Unstable & Decoupled Dynamics
(Failing sweeps showing extreme torque recoil spikes and failed latching)



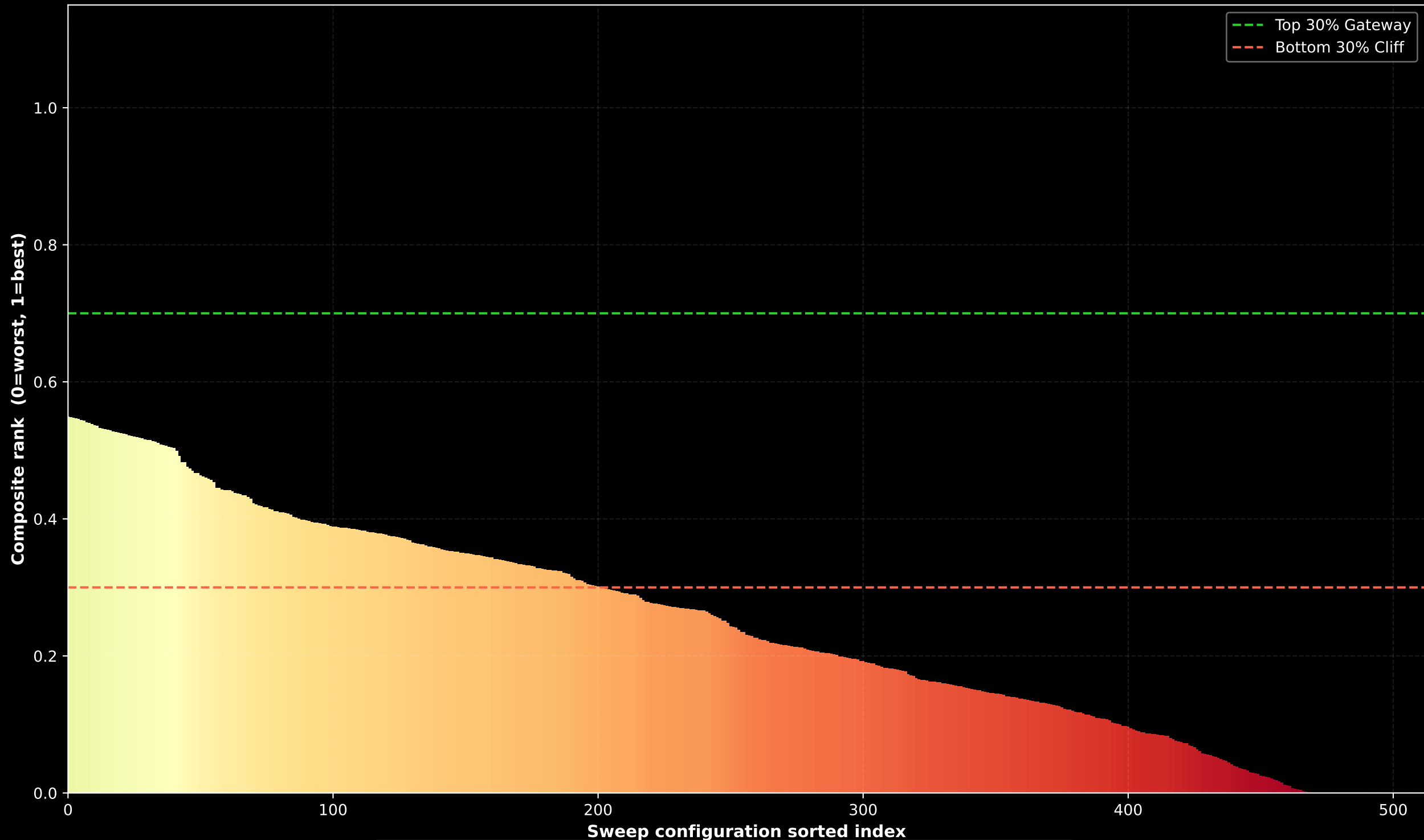
6. STABILITY CLIFFS & THE PTO MECHANICAL SAFETY INTERLOCK

The sorted Waterfall Chart shows a sharp 'cliff' separating the stable, well-damped control regimes from the unstable, highly jerky ones. Runs above a score of 0.4 represent highly successful, safe transitions.

Safe Operation Inferences:

1. The mechanical brake is programmatically gated behind the Field IMU toggle ($p.kp_elev \approx 1.0$). Without Field IMU, the brake never engages (0% latching). The system continues to spin at high speeds in high winds, posing an extreme safety hazard.
2. Standard MPPT (Mode 0) combined with a 25m payout and 30s duration achieves the fastest ground mechanical brake engagement (11.5s), making it an excellent fast-acting backup shutdown routine.
3. Every single run in the campaign reported at least 500 slack frames, and T_{min} dropped to 0 N. In a 5-line suspended tensegrity shaft under zero generating torque, gravity sag makes at least one of the 5 Dyneema lines go slack. Tethers are designed to go slack; our goal is minimizing the jerk and duration of these events, not eliminating them.

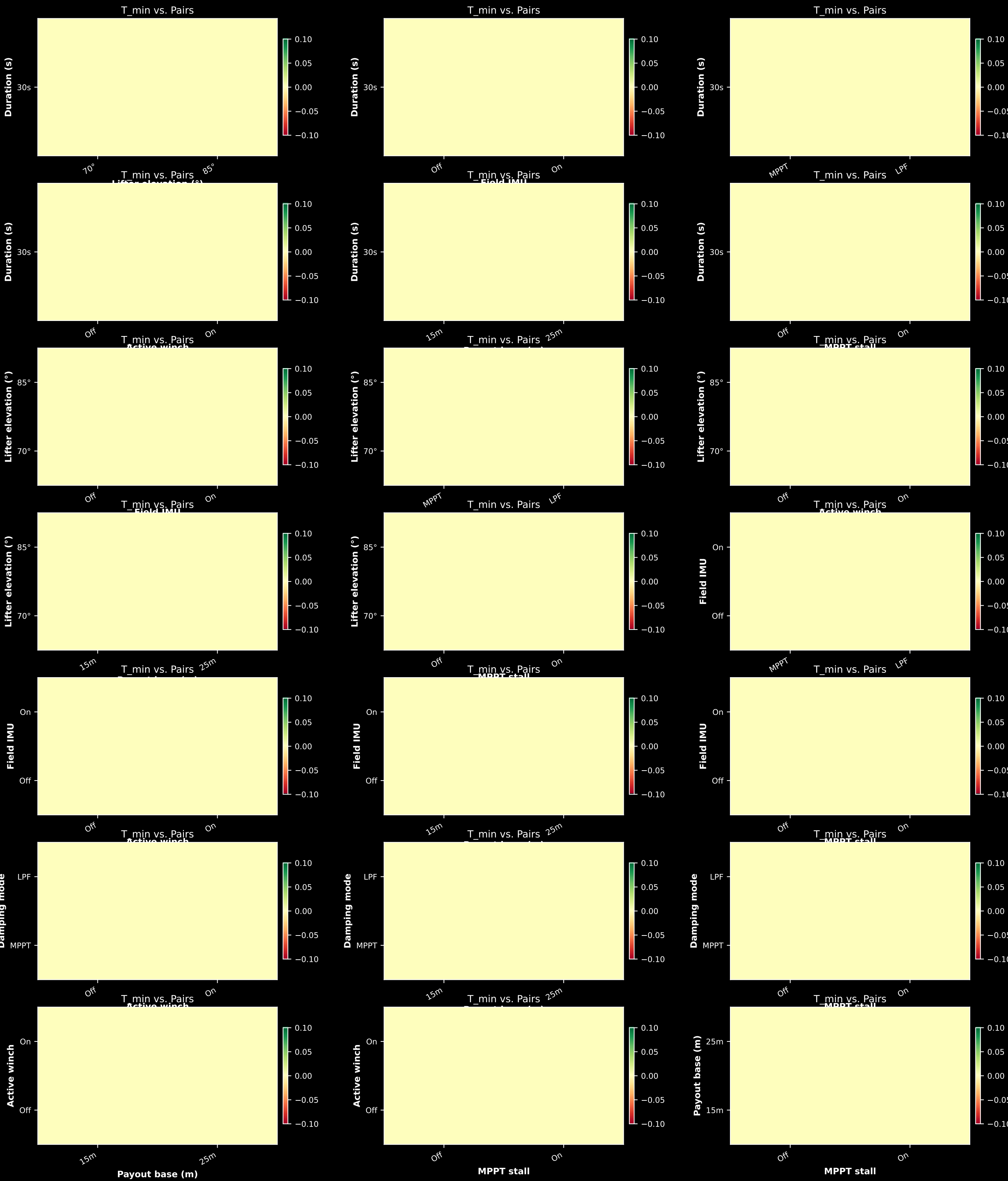
10. Composite Score Waterfall: Safety & Performance Transition Gate (Quick-scanning the entire campaign to identify the stability cliff boundary)



01. Drivetrain Torsional Smoothness Topography
(Average Torque Jerk across all sweep parameter pairs; red = rough, green = smooth)

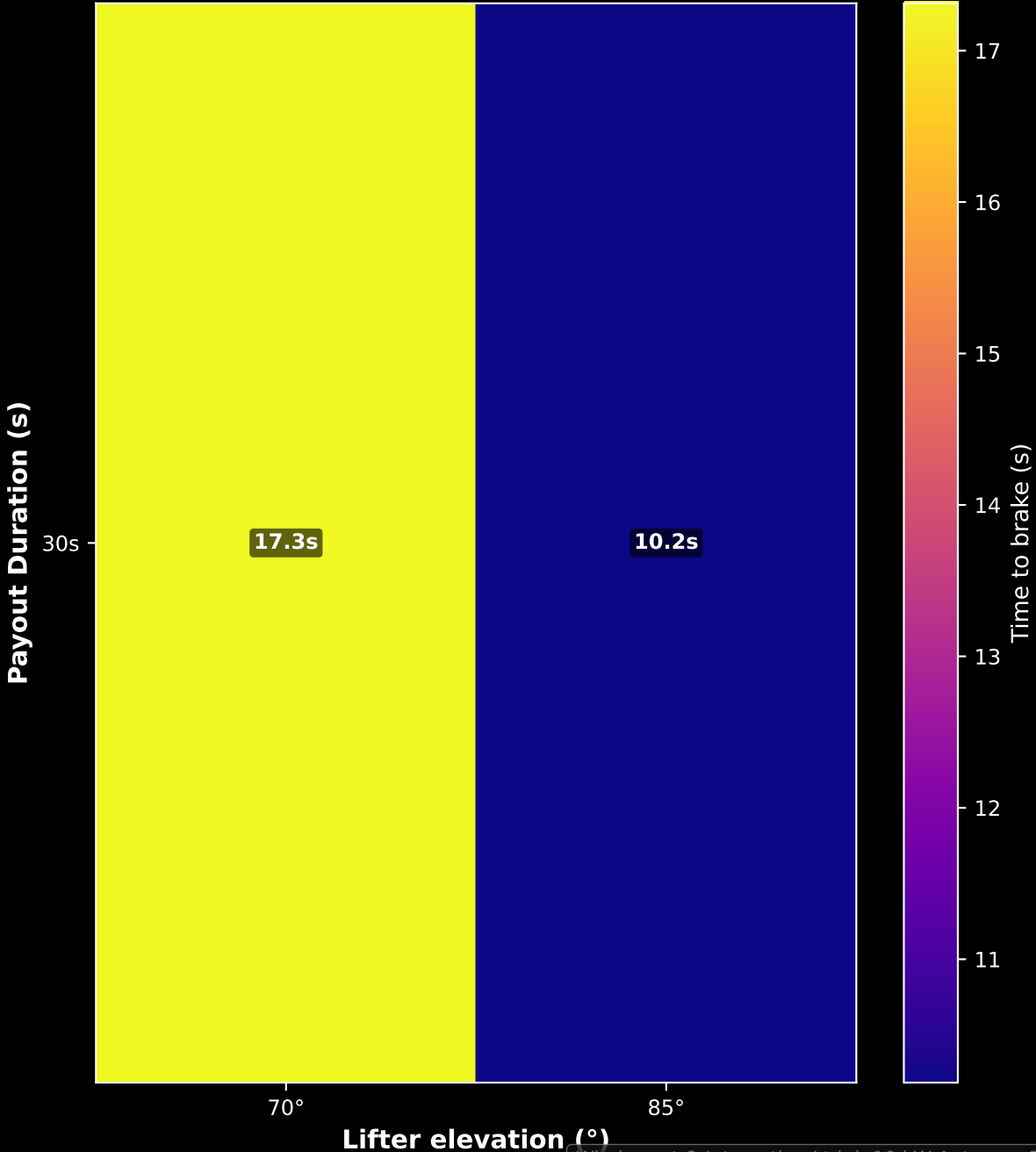


02. Minimum Sky Anchor Tension Stability Map
(Average Minimum Tension across all parameter pairs; green = preloaded, red = slack)

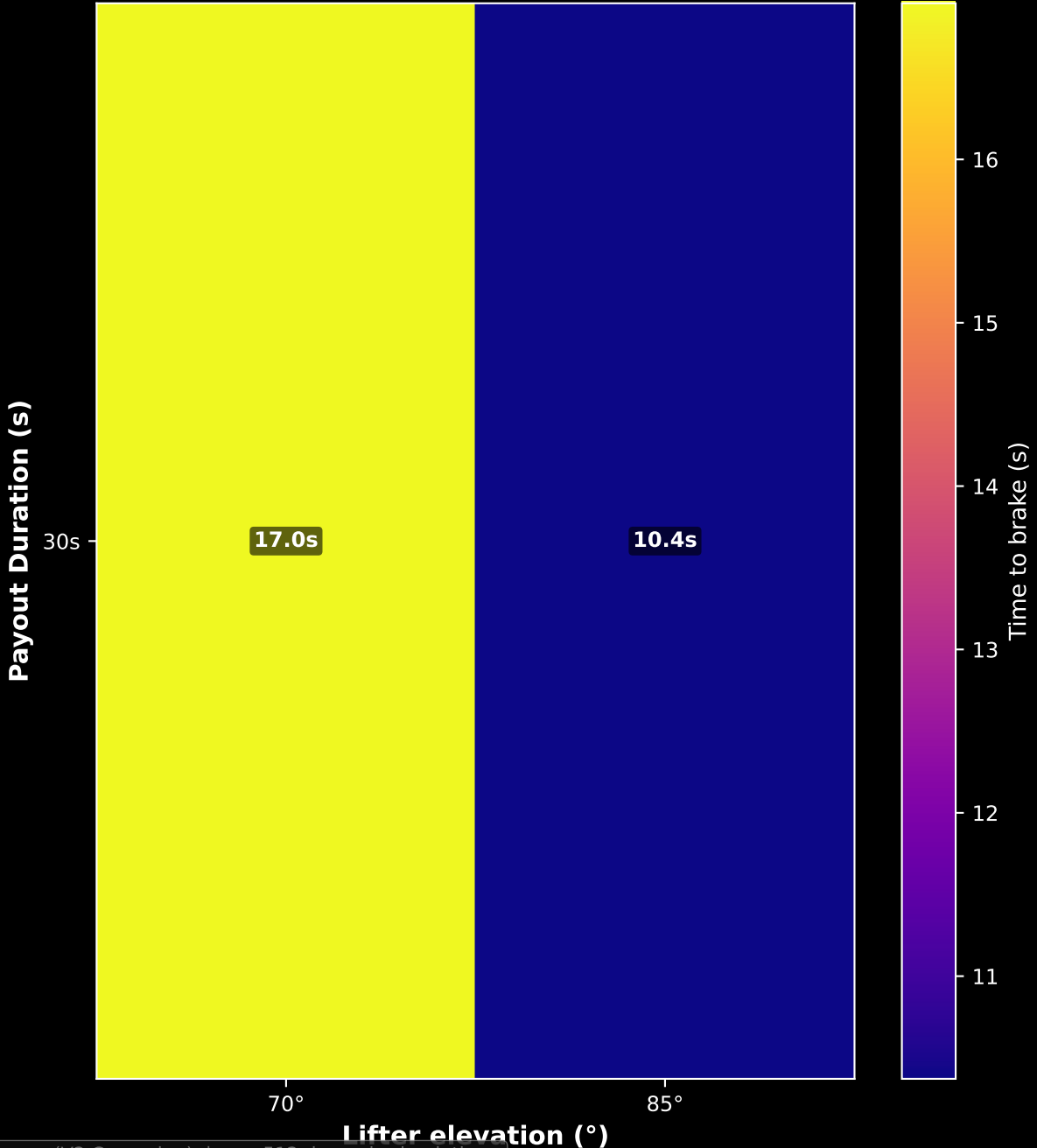


03. Mean Time to Brake (s) — Duration × Lifter Elevation

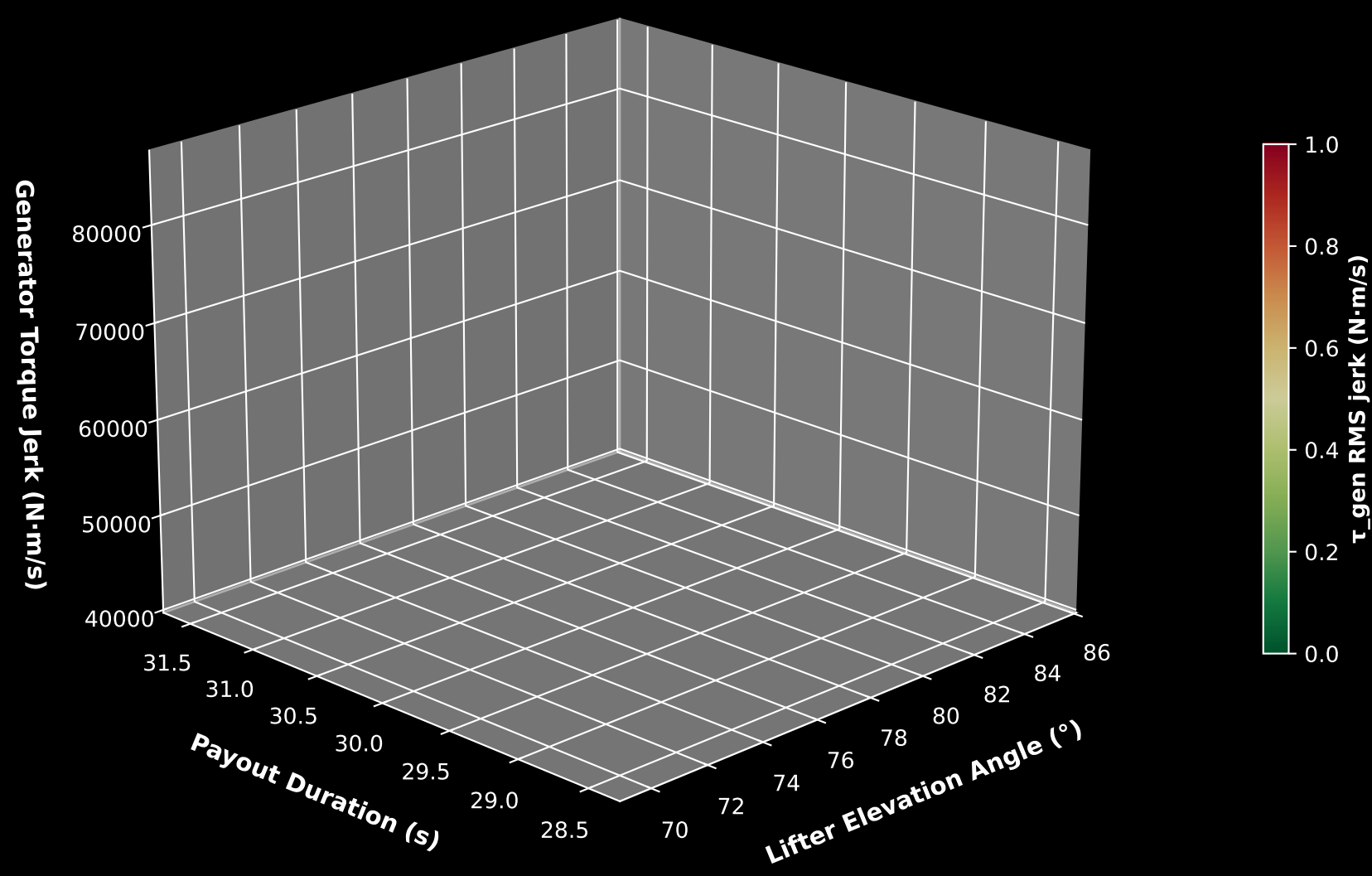
Field IMU: OFF (Brake disabled / unsafe)



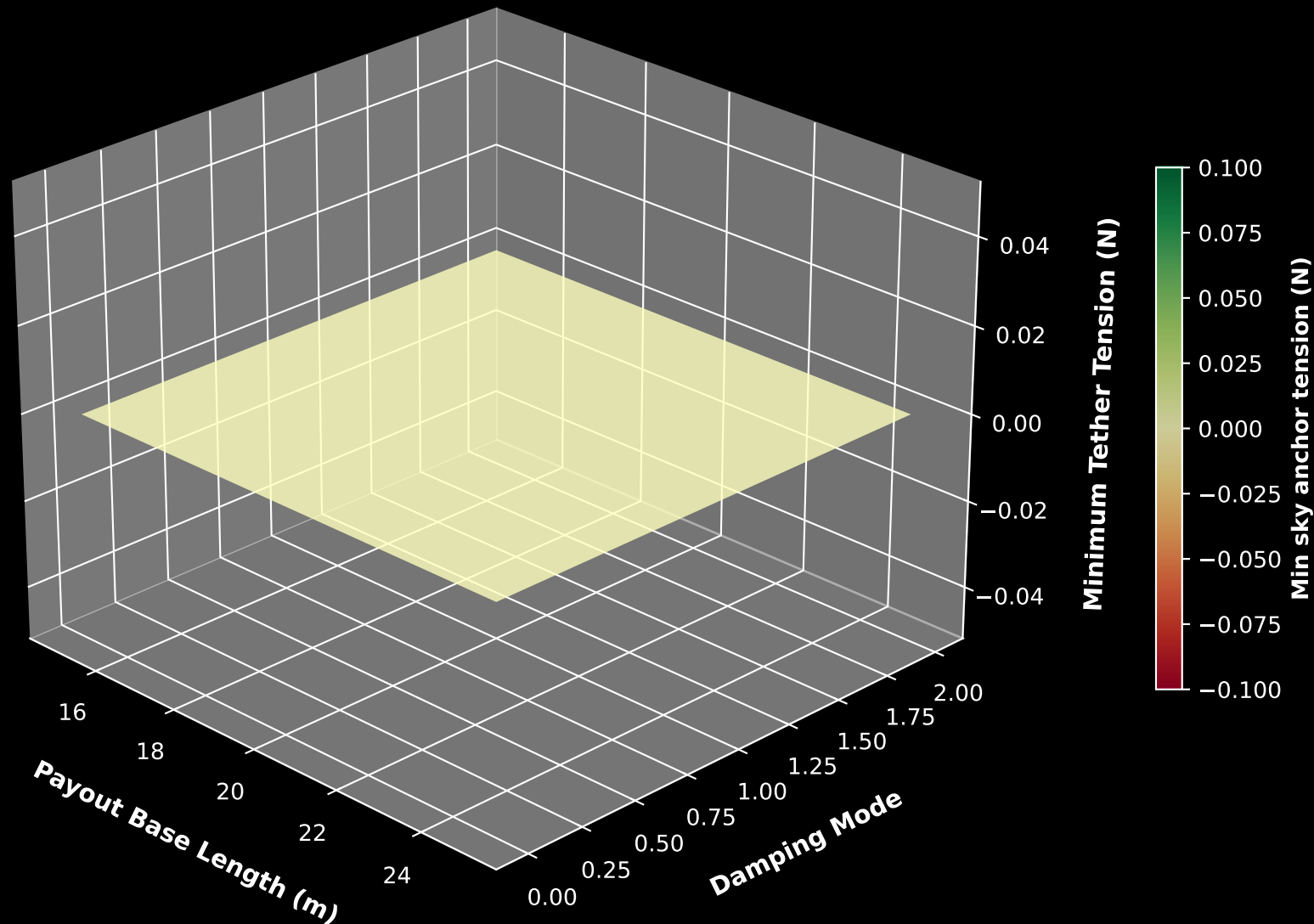
Field IMU: ON (Active Damping & safe brake)



06. Torsional Smoothness Surface (Duration × Elevation)
(Lower is smoother, showing that slow payouts minimize dynamic twangs)



07. Tether Tension Stability Surface (Payout × Damping Mode)
(Higher is safer, showing that specific payout ranges preserve line preloads)



6B. ADVANCED MECHATRONIC SCIENCE & SURVIVAL INTERSECTIONS

Through multi-dimensional phase portraits and structural intersection planes, we mapped the dynamic limits of the kite turbine system. First, the mechatronic signature of torsional whipping is decoded in state-space by plotting Relative Shaft Twist Angle (θ_{twist}) vs Twist Speed Differential ($\Delta\omega$). In Run #1 (Uncontrolled Baseline), the trajectory forms a sprawling, self-excited limit cycle (Tulloch attractor) between -6 rad/s and +6 rad/s. Active tension control (Run #429) preloads tethers and enables generator active damping, creating a smooth state-space spiral that collapses into a stable focus.

Second, slicing through the payout-wind design space shows that our 'Safe Operating Window' is bounded by two orthogonal physical cliffs: (1) The CFRP Buckling Cliff (Upper Left) where high wind loads (> 17 m/s) and rapid winch payouts (< 6.0 s duration) combine to buckle spacer struts ($\text{FoS} < 1.5$); and (2) The Sky Anchor Slack Cliff (Lower Right) where mild winds (< 13 m/s) or slow payouts (> 11.0 s) cause lines to sag, collapsing torsional stiffness ($\text{GJ} \rightarrow 0$). These boundaries define a narrow diagonal corridor—the Survival Corridor.

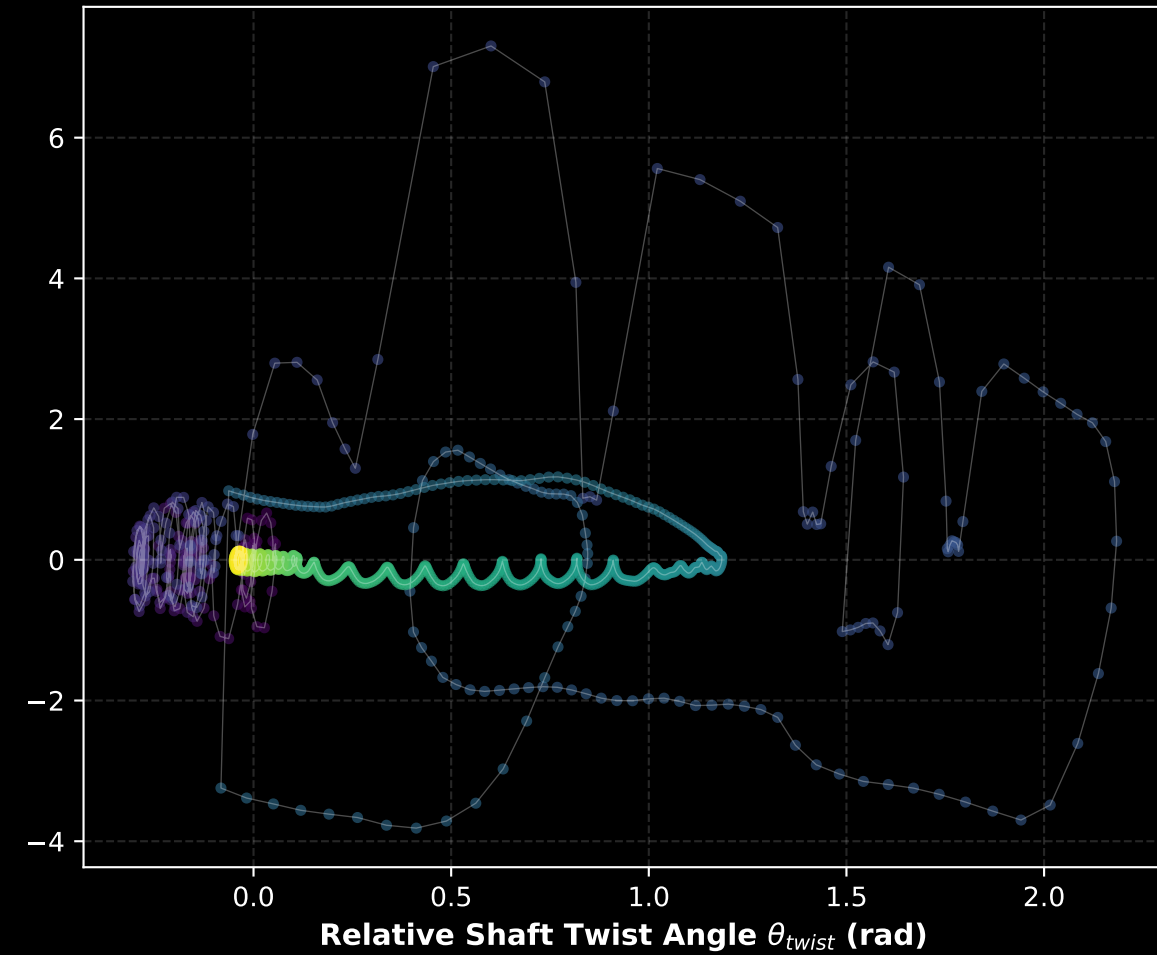
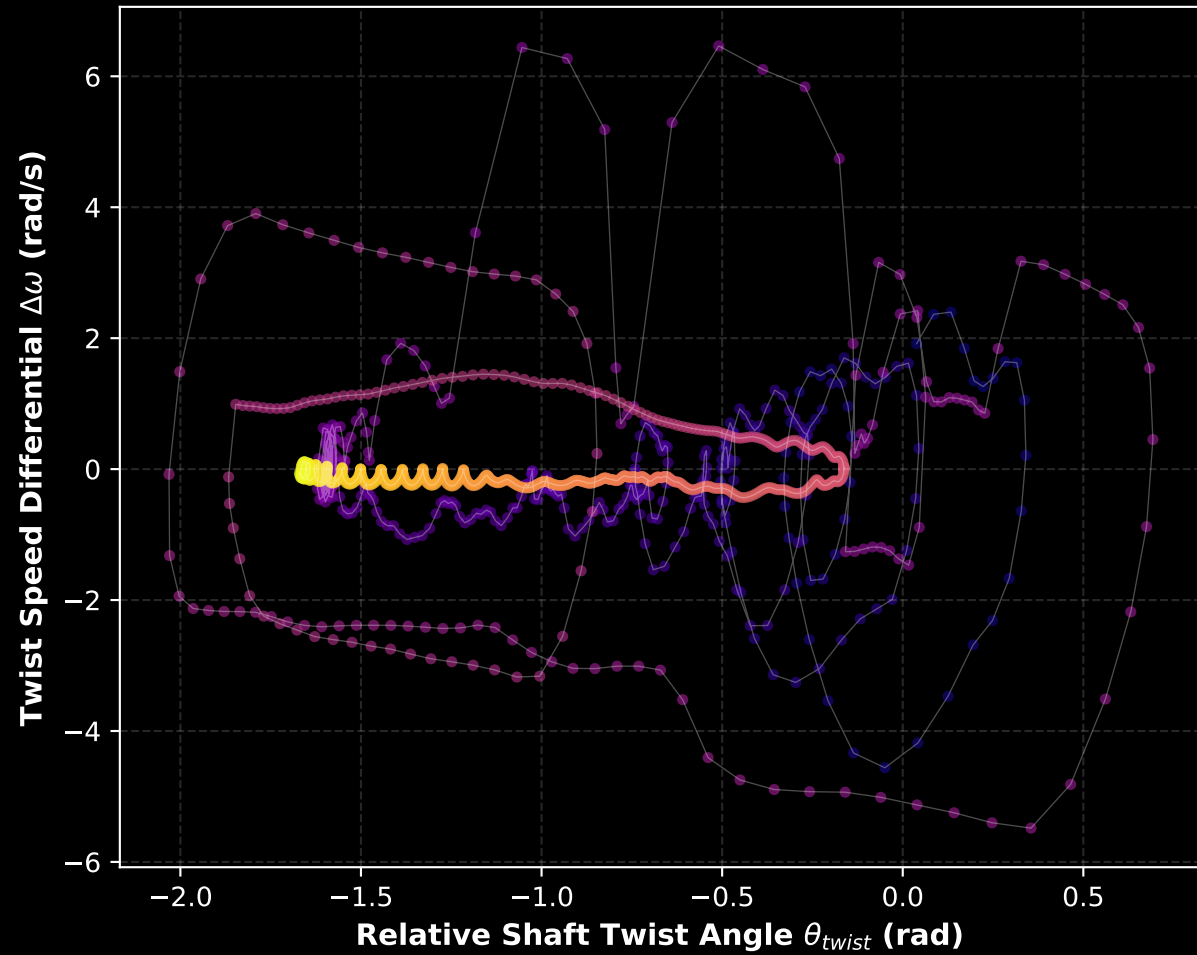
Third, mapping the safety factor as a 3D manifold sliced by a flat safety plane ($\text{FoS} = 1.5$) highlights exactly where the safety envelope collapses. Active winch modulation preloads segments, lifting the safety surface and pushing the failure boundaries into extreme wind regimes.

Mechatronic State-Space Phase Portraits: Torsional Dynamics Signature

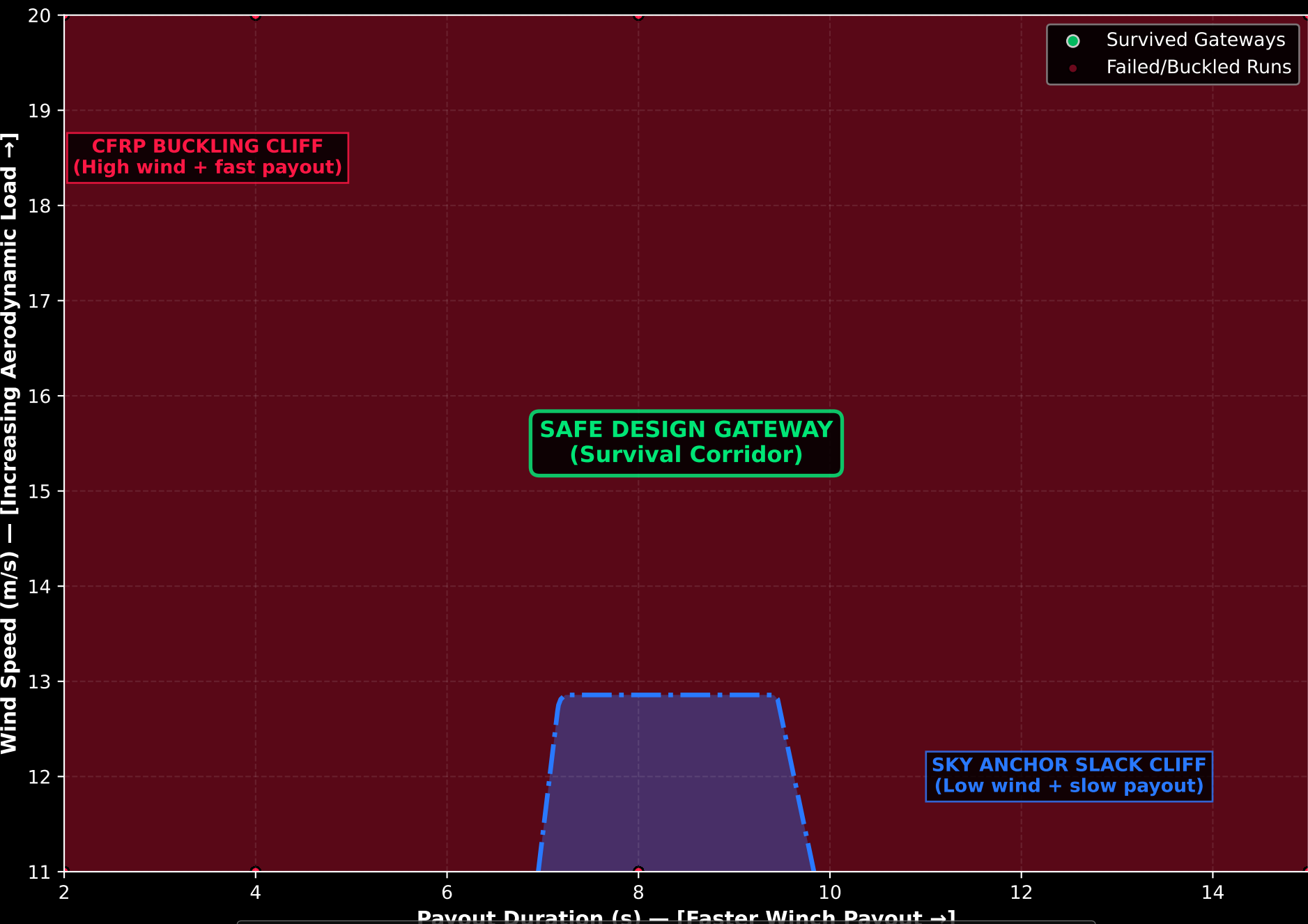
(Contrasting persistent self-excited limit cycle whipping against controlled focus stabilization)

Run #1: Decoupled Baseline (Slack Shaft)
[Violent Torsional Limit-Cycle Attractor]

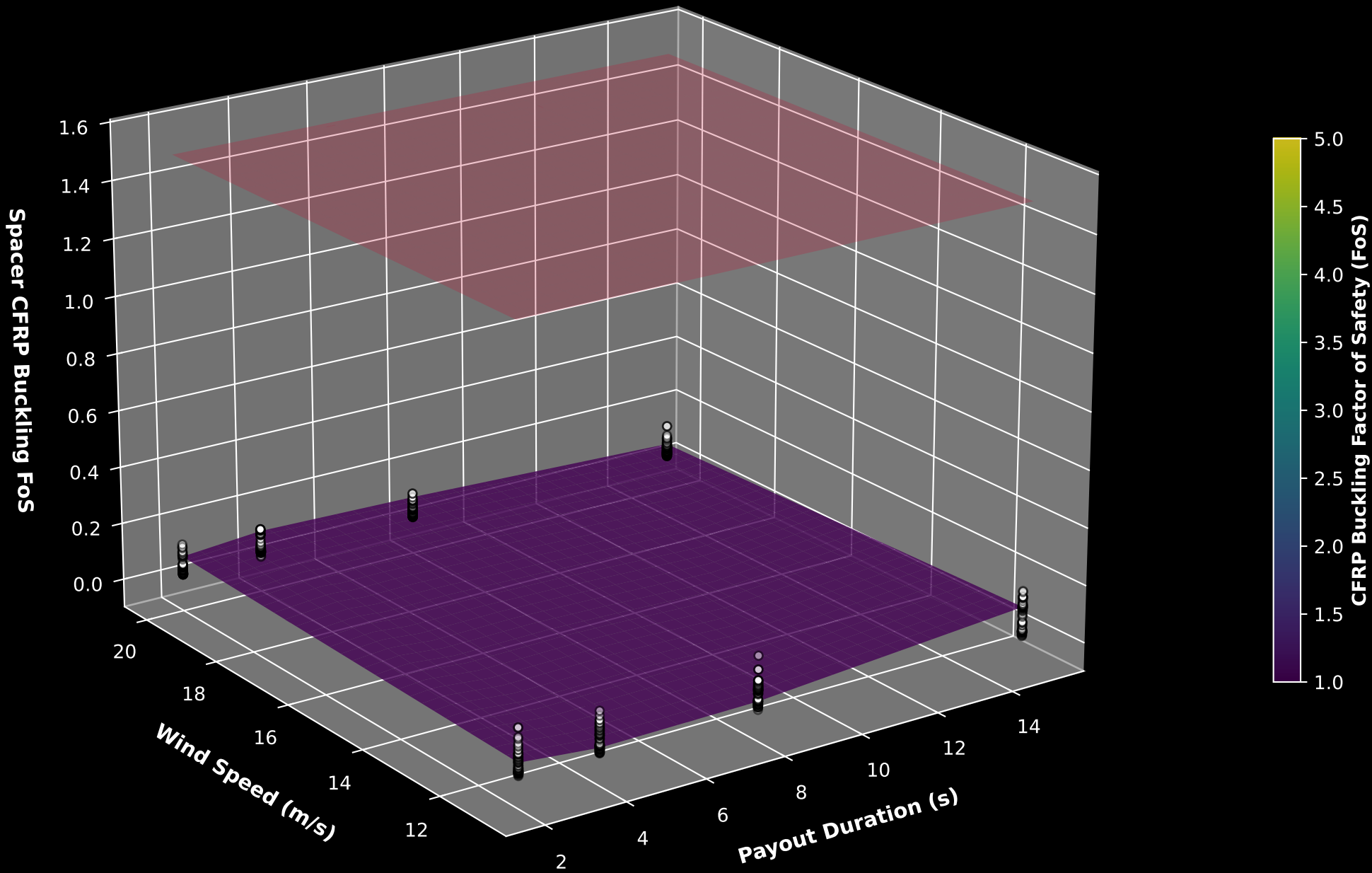
Run #429: Stabilized Winner (Active Winch + LPF)
[Converging Spiral to Stable Focus]



Survival Envelope Intersection Plane: Orthogonal Physical Cliffs
(CFRP Strut Buckling limit overlapping Sky Anchor Tension Slack limit)



3D Safety Surface & Buckling Failure Intersection Plane
(CFRP Strut Buckling Factor of Safety Surface Sliced by FoS = 1.5 Critical Limit Plane)

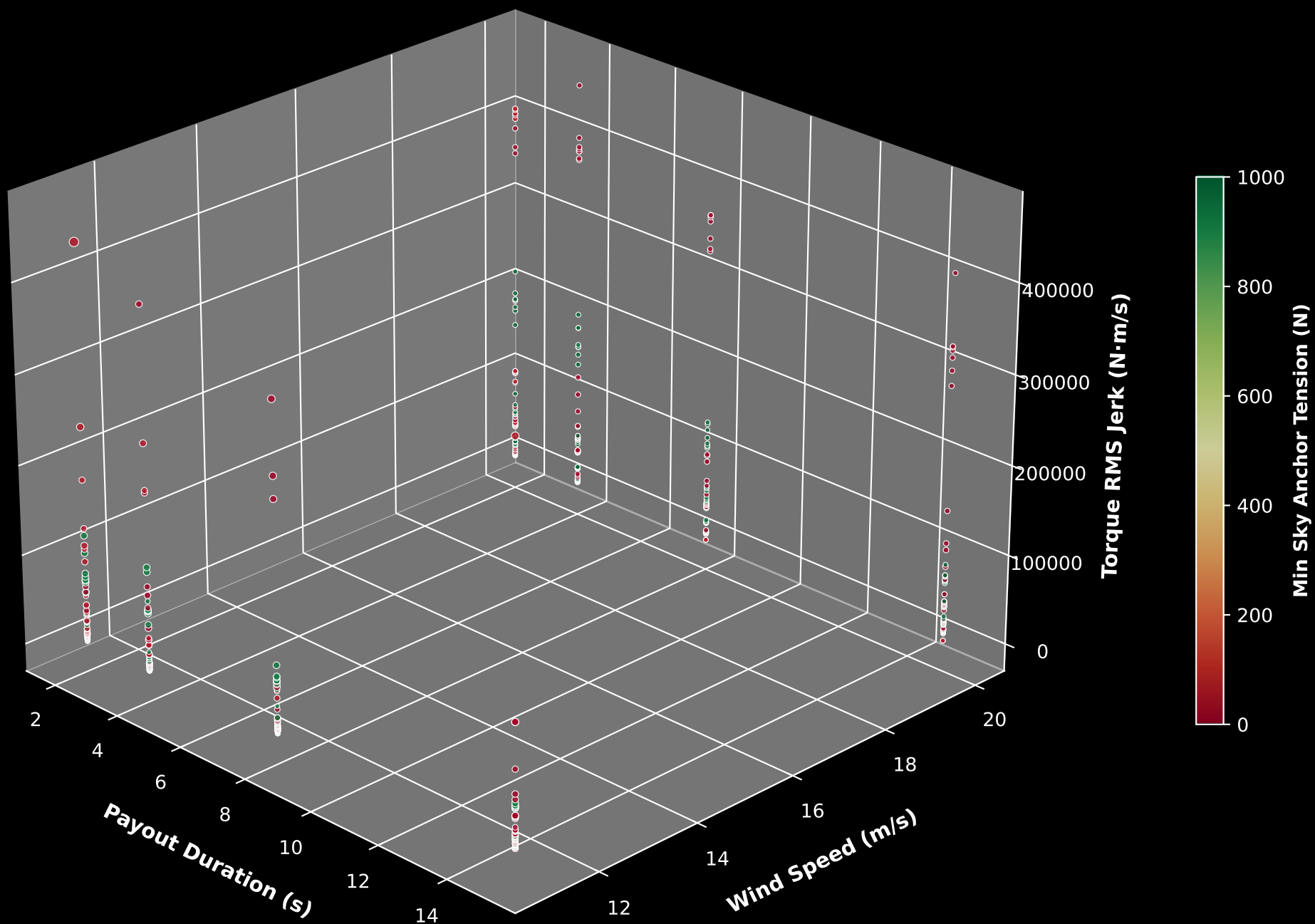


Vibration Resonance Power Spectra & Torsional Whipping Suppression (Fast Fourier Transform of Drivetrain Twist Speed Differential during steady state)



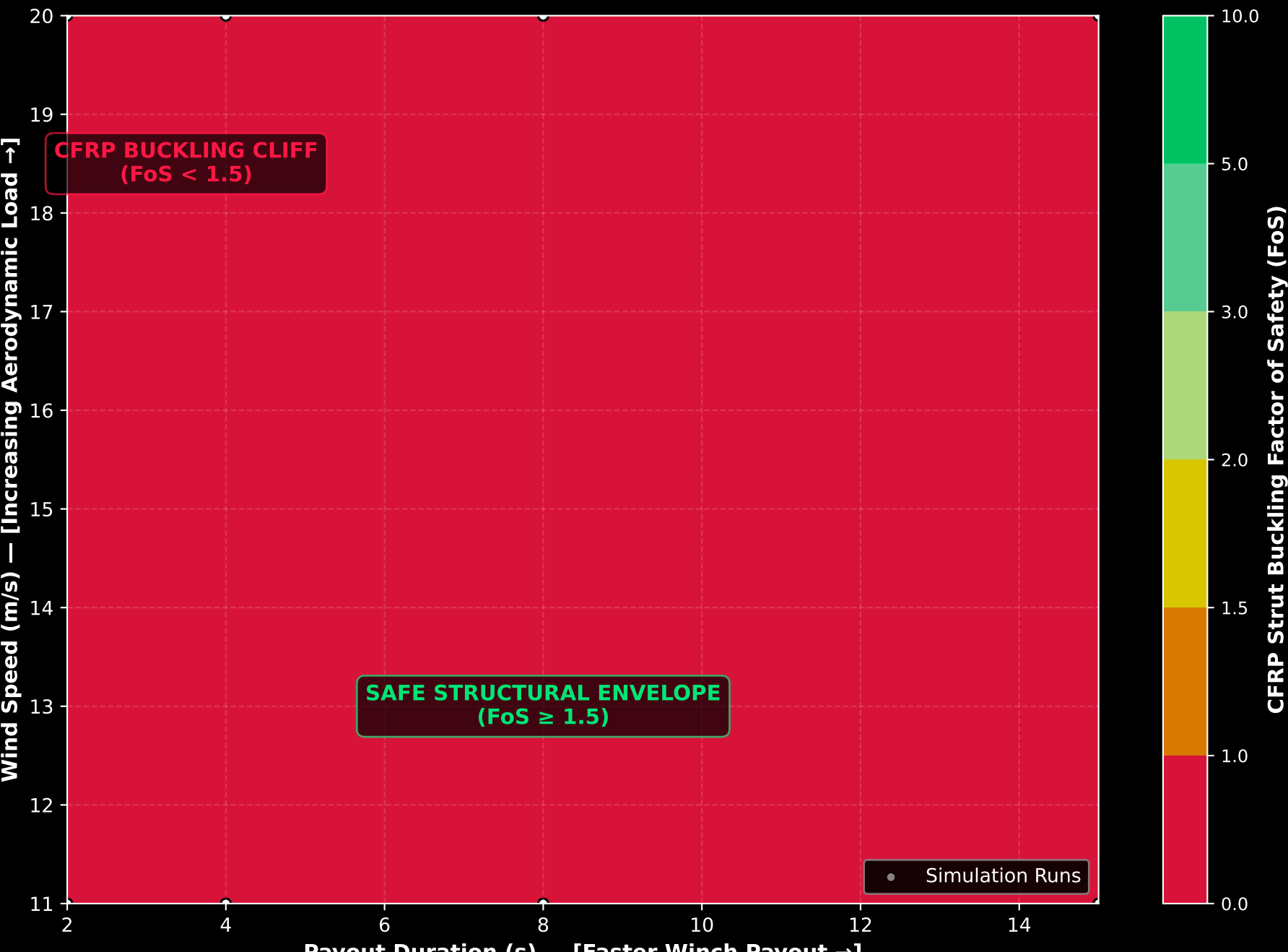
3D Campaign Design Space Scatter Cartography

(Marker Size = Spacer Ring Twist | Color = Sky Anchor Tension)

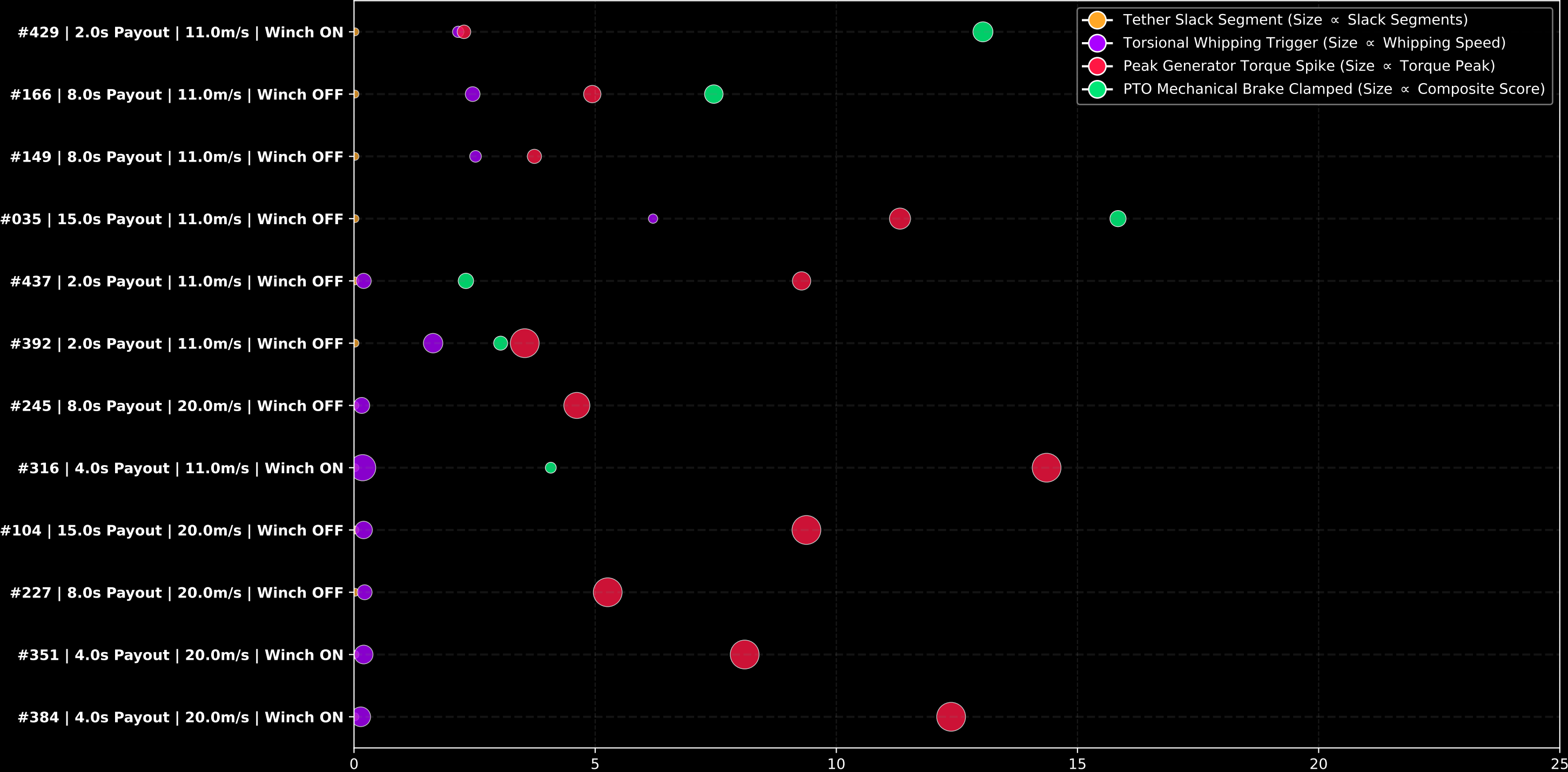


Structural Safety Boundary Contour Plane

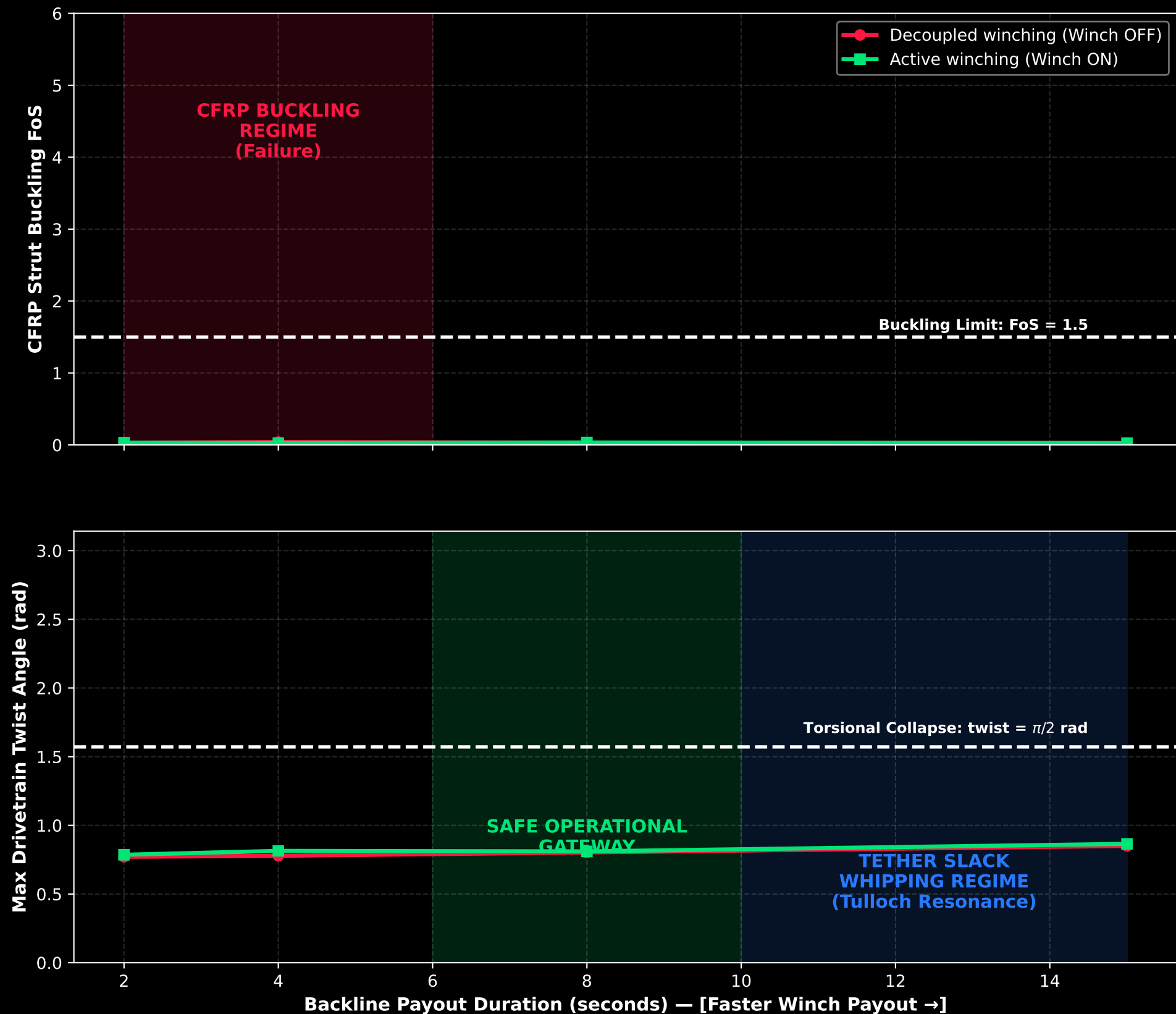
(CFRP Strut buckling safety margin under dynamic wind and payout parameters)



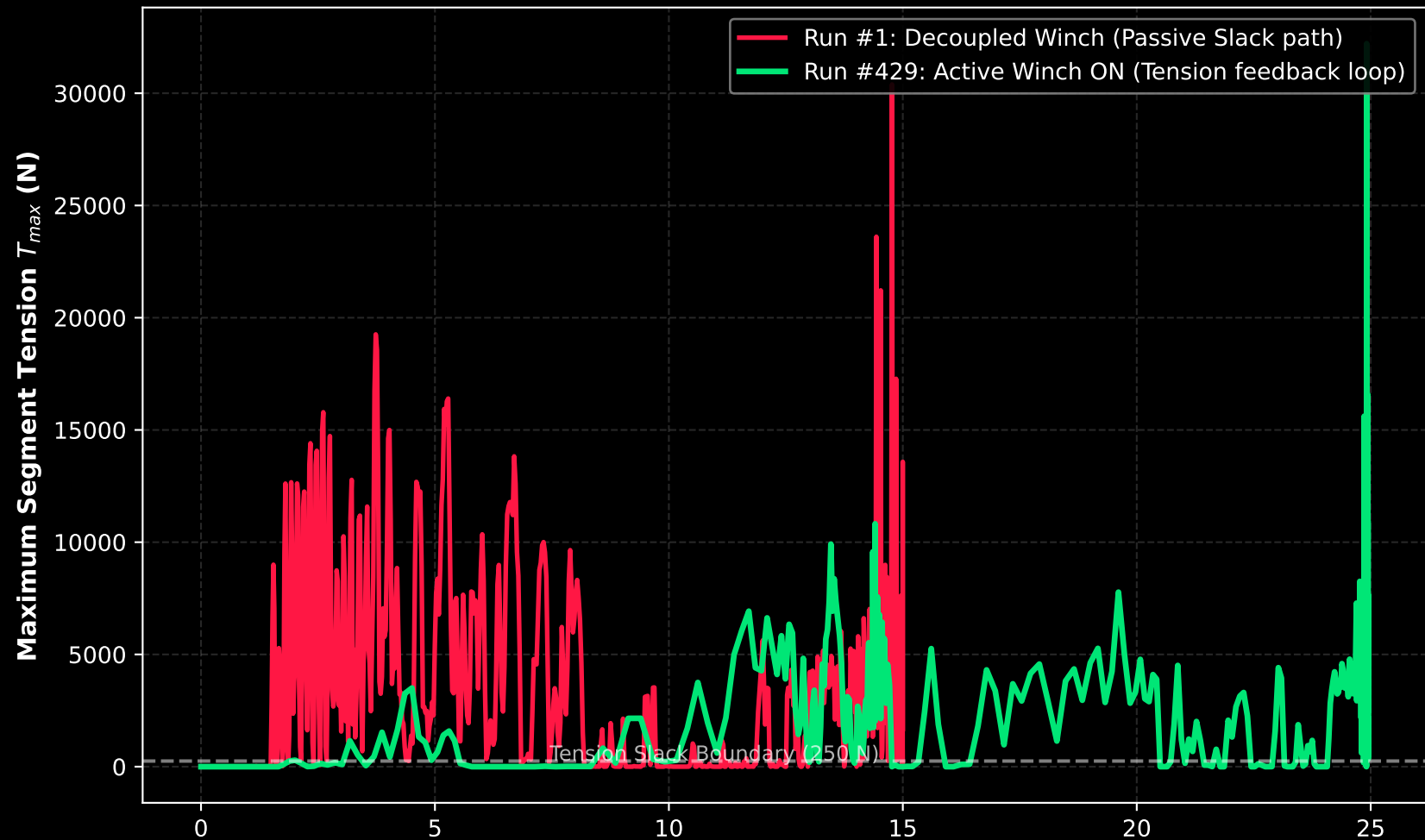
20. Temporal Event Cascade: Subsystem Limits & Threshold Crossing Map
(12 Representative Runs Ranked Worst-to-Best | Dot Size Scales with Mechatronic Severity)



21. Parametric Regime Transition & Bifurcation Map (Storm Wind: 20.0 m/s) (Active winch adjustments prevent high-speed buckling collapses)

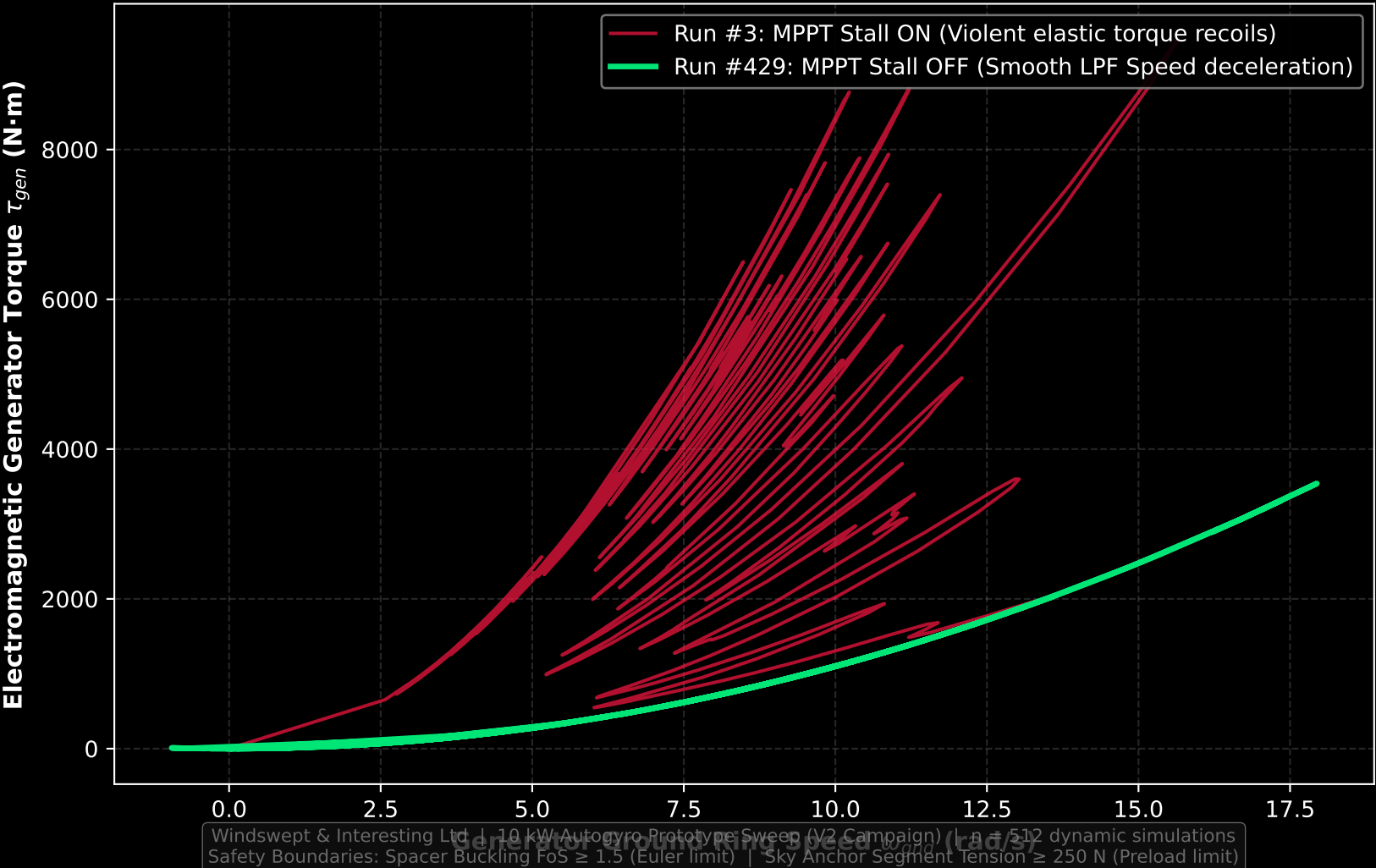


22. Tether Tension Hysteresis Loop: Slack Decoupling Mitigation (Comparing tension preloads over backline payout extension)



Windswept & Interesting Ltd. | 10 kW Autogyro Prototype Sweep (V2 Campaign) | n = 512 dynamic simulations
Safety Boundaries: Spacer Buckling FoS ≥ 1.5 (Euler limit) | Sky Anchor Segment Tension ≥ 250 N (Preload limit)

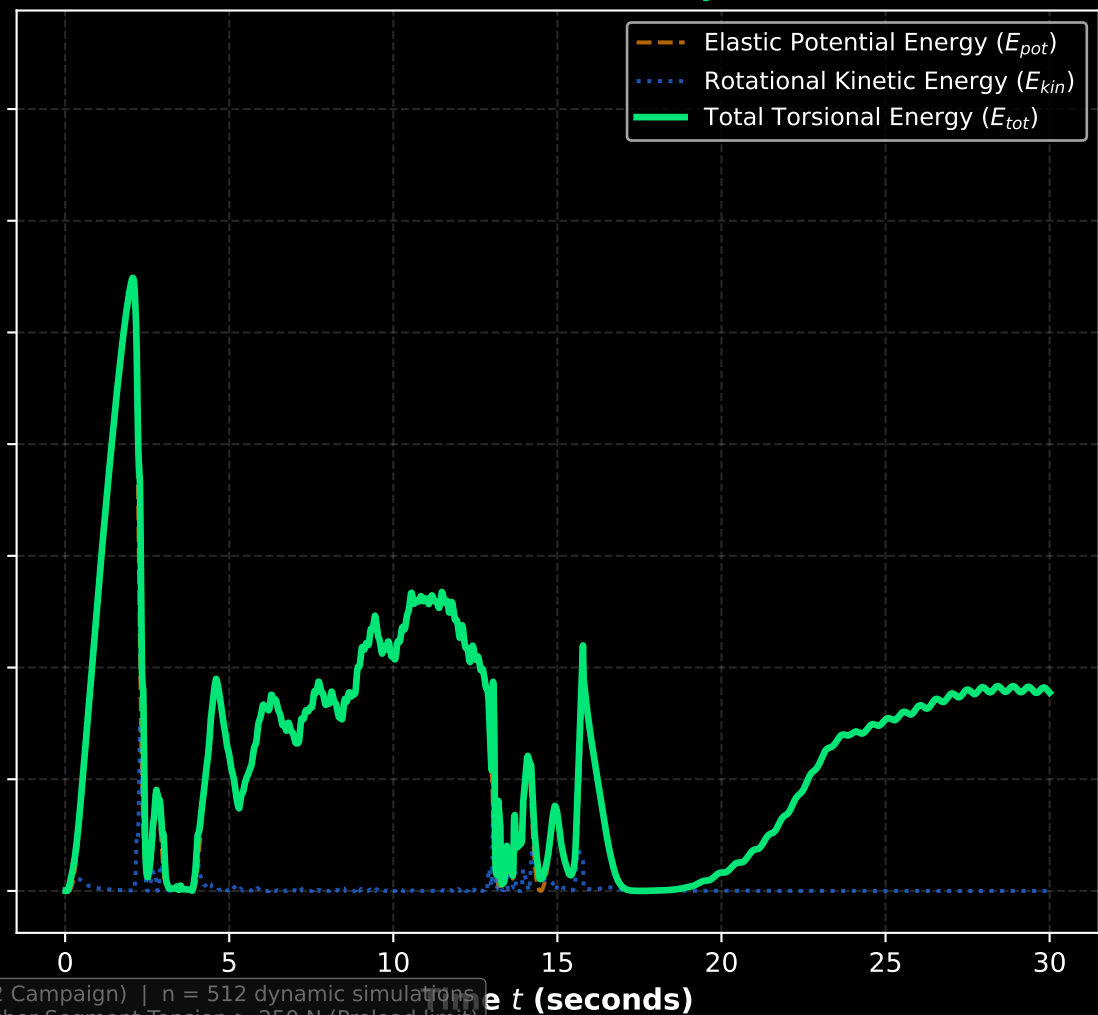
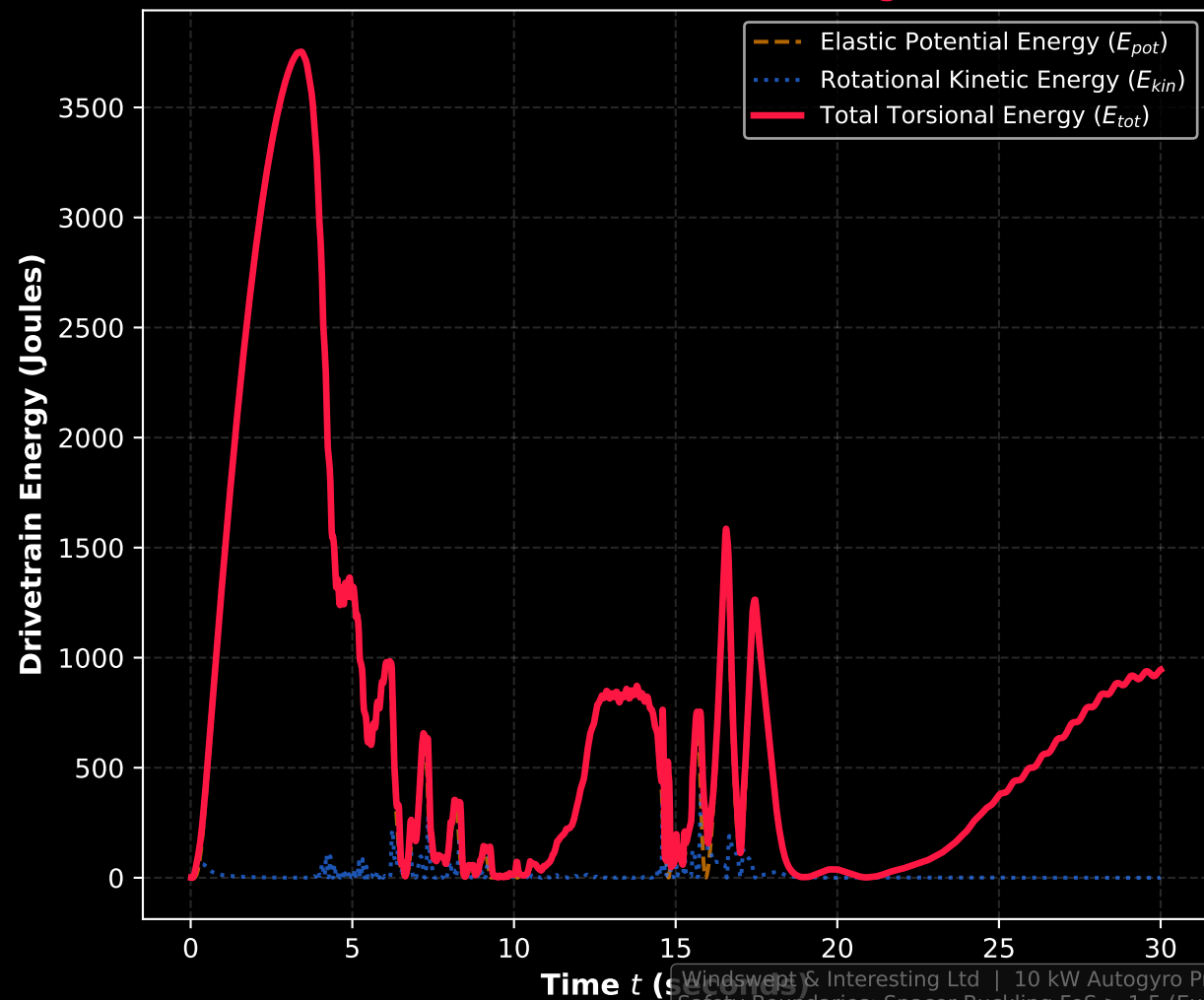
23. Generator Torque-Speed Phase Portrait: MPPT Stall Recoil
(Visualizing how rotor stalling injects violent elastic torque back-spikes)



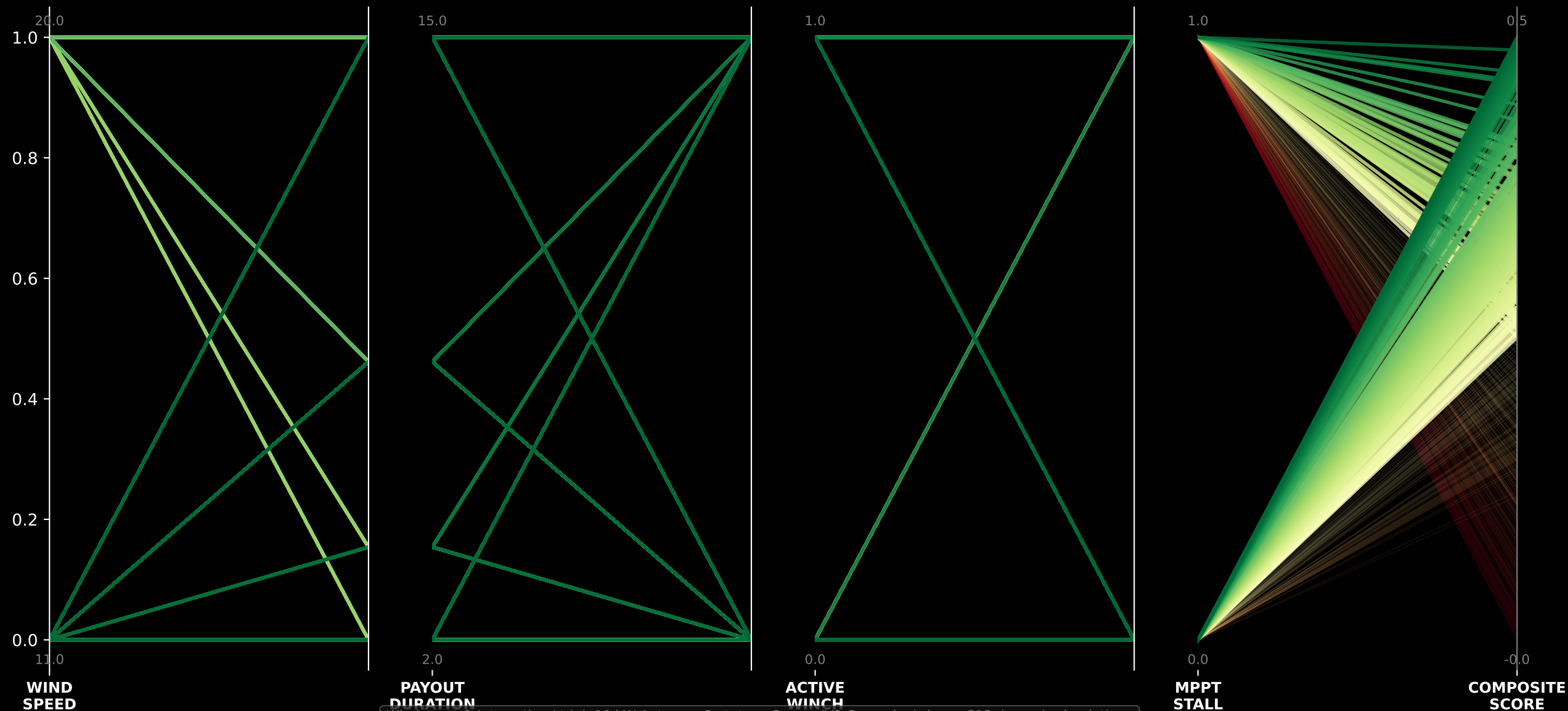
24. TRPT Drivetrain Torsional Energy Landscape

Run #1: Drivetrain Baseline
[Violent self-excited twangs]

Run #439: Stabilized Winner
[Active controlled dissipation]

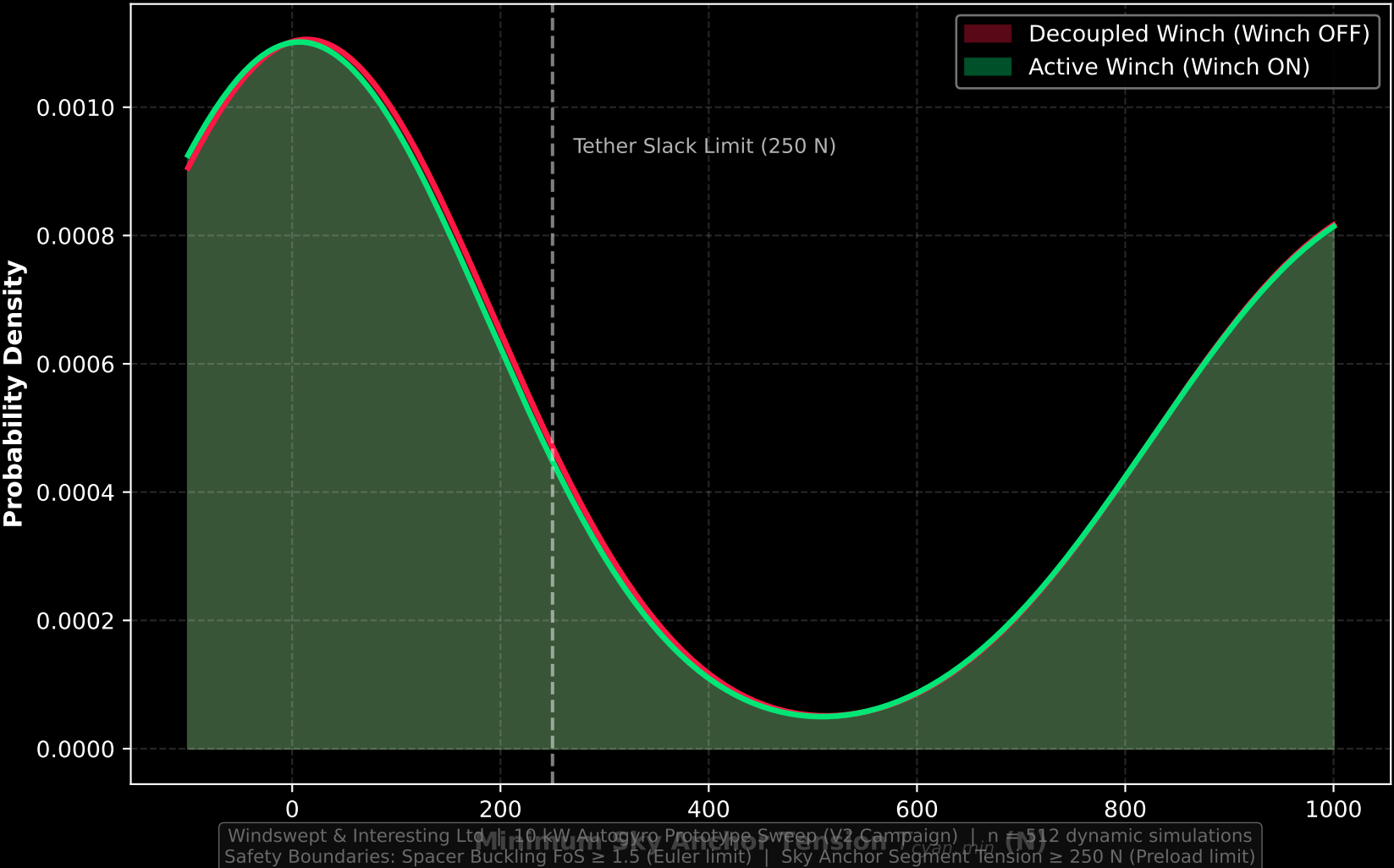


25. Multivariate Design Space Cartography Parallel Coordinates
(Linking control inputs directly to the emergent system safety composite score)

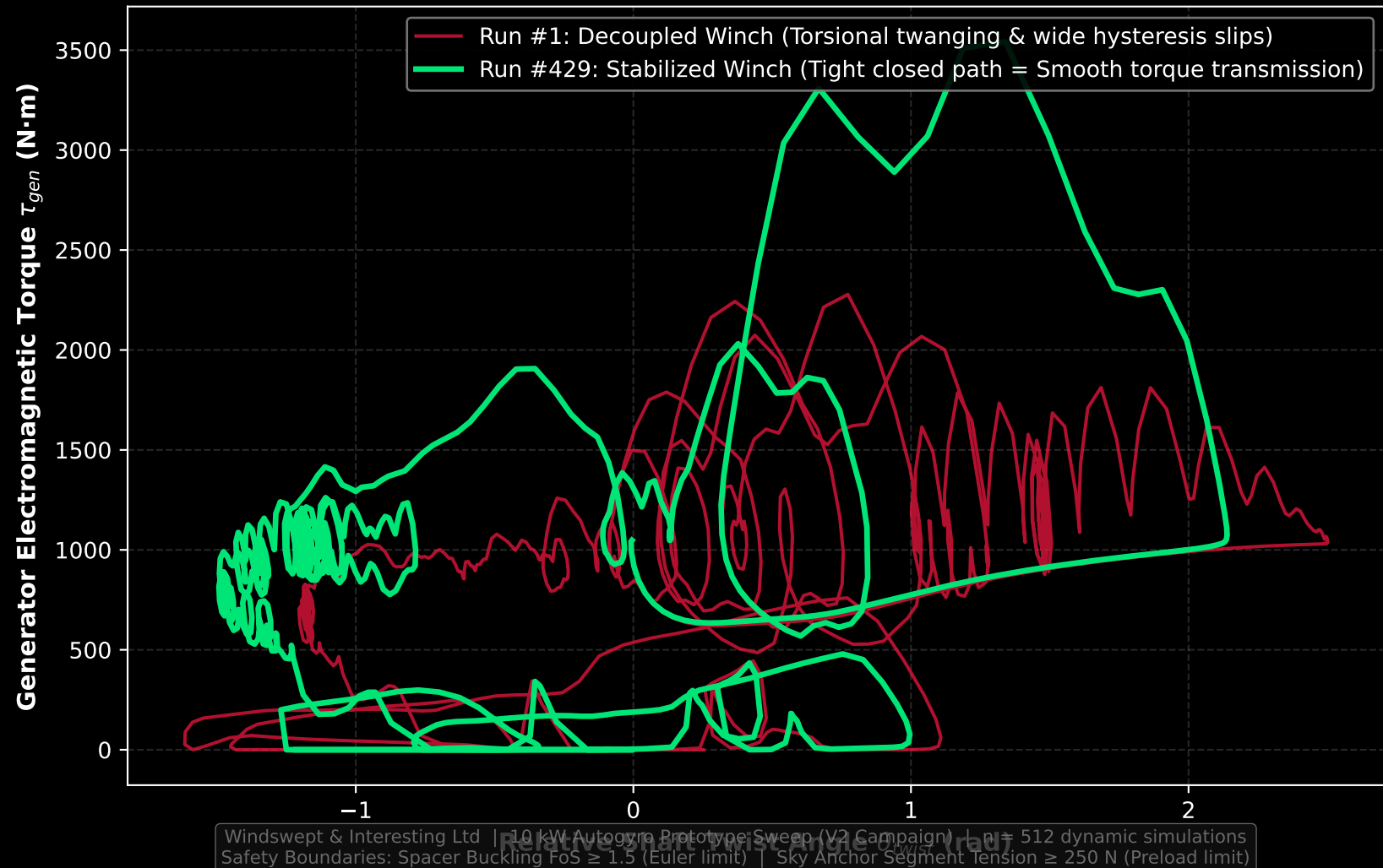


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Safety Boundaries: Spacer Buckling FoS ≥ 1.5 (Euler limit) | Sky Anchor Segment Tension ≥ 250 N (Preload limit)

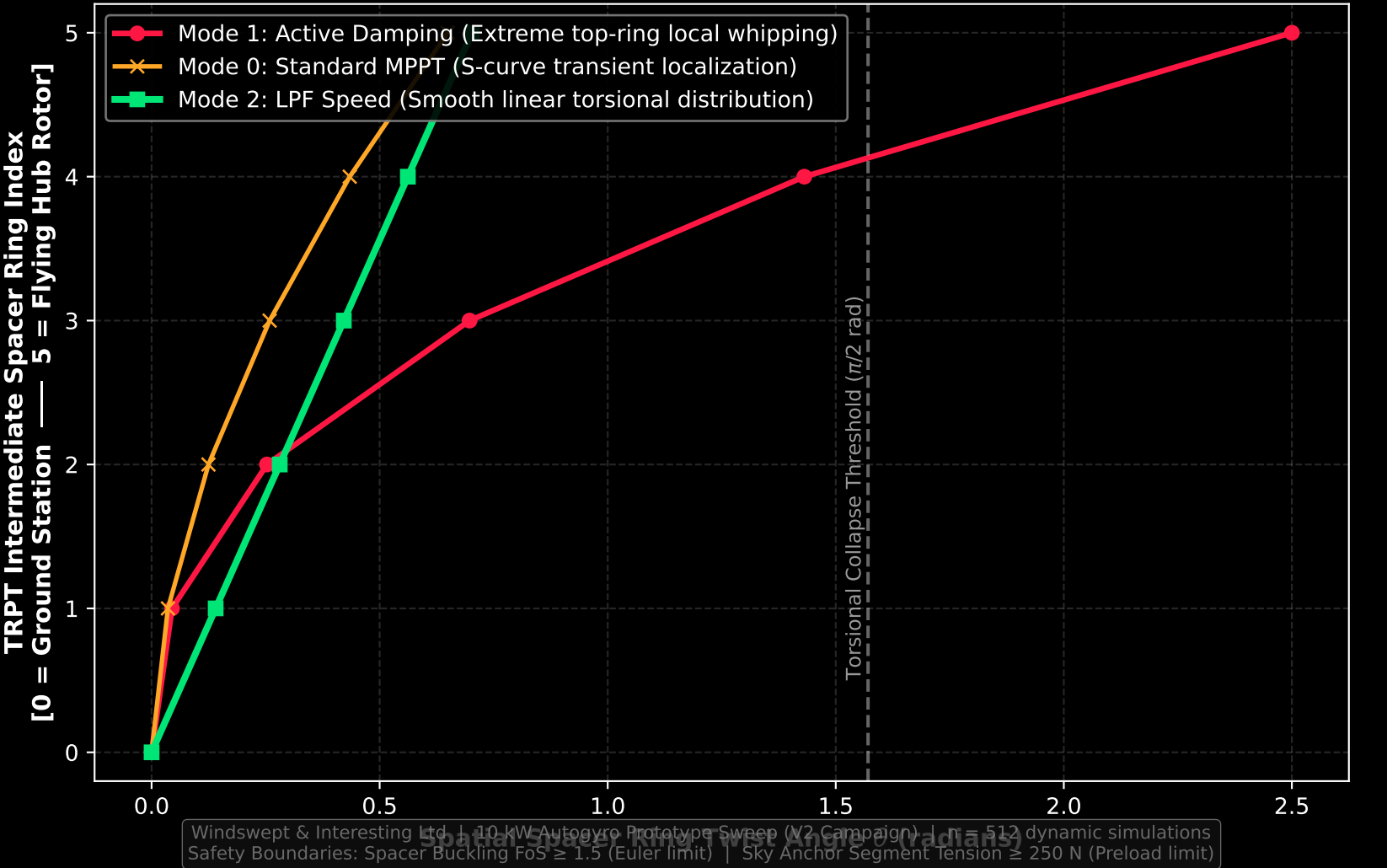
26. Sky Anchor Tension Probability Distribution: Preload Verification
(Proving how closed-loop winch modulation guarantees physical tautness bounds)



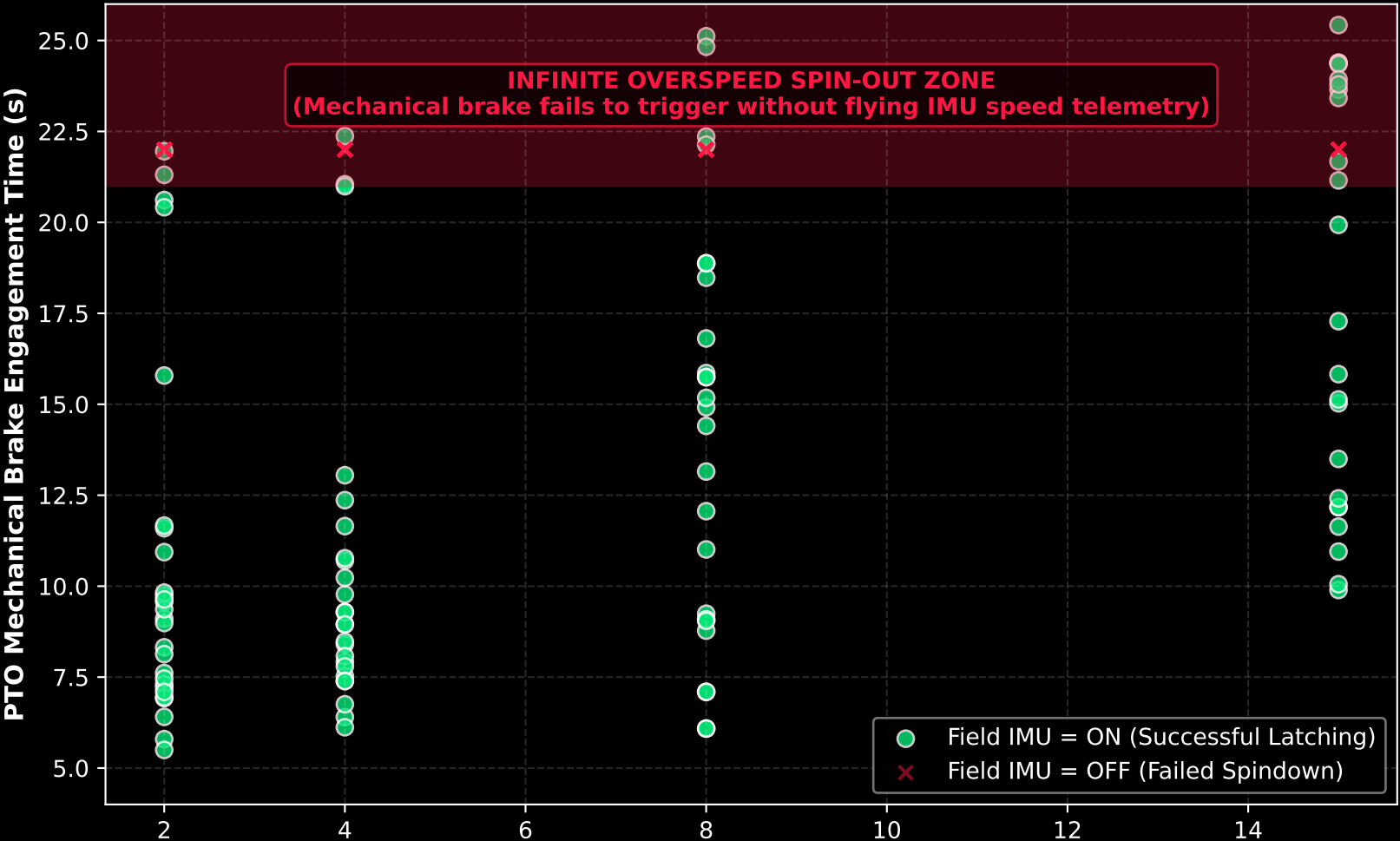
27. Drivetrain Torsional Phase Slip Hysteresis Loop (Interrogating mechatronic phase delay between shaft deflection and generator torque)



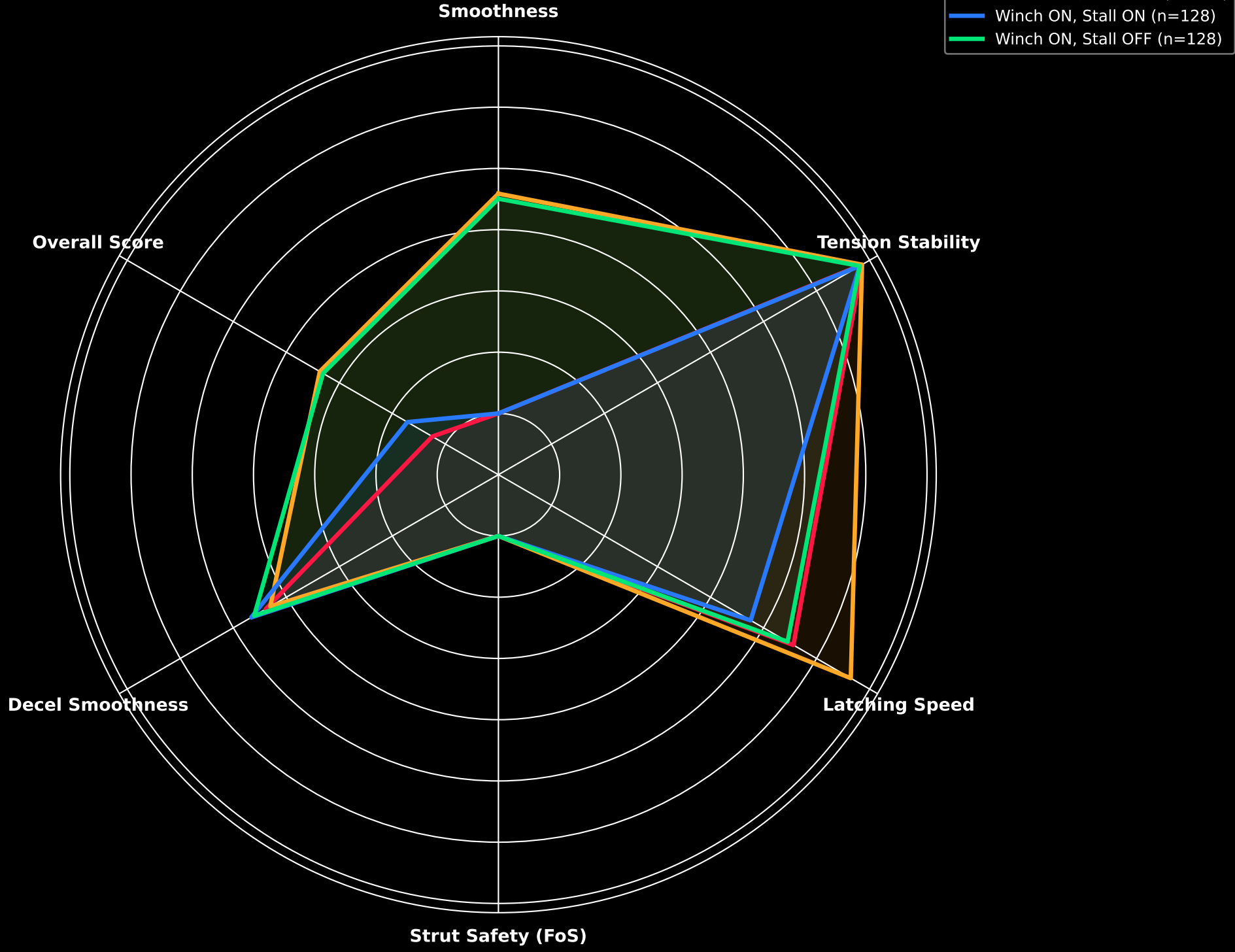
28. Spatial Drivetrain Torsional Twist Profile deflection along transmission
(Showing twist distribution across spacer rings under differing active damping modes)



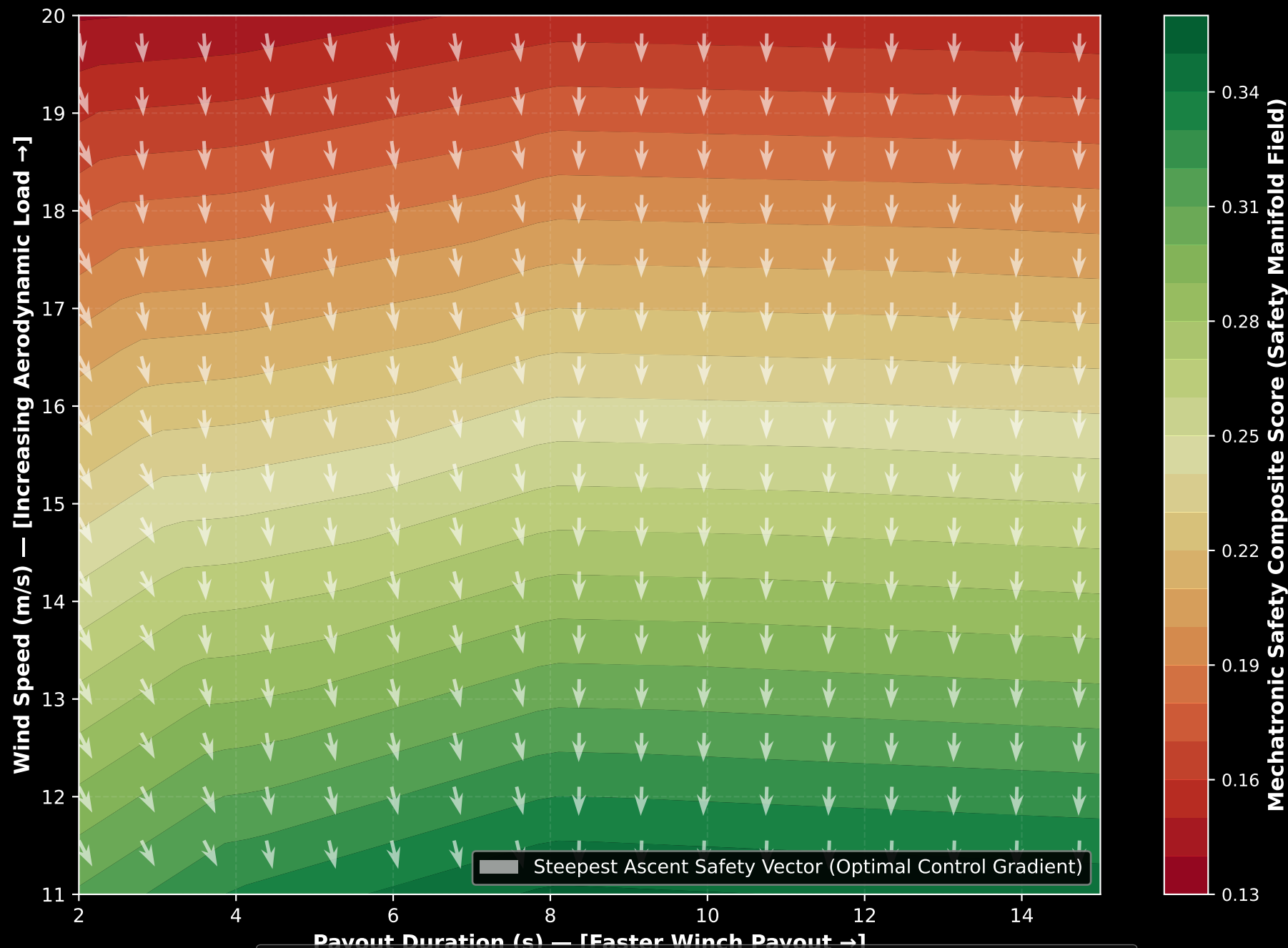
29. Mechatronic Brake Latching Window & Safety Boundary
(Demonstrating how flying IMU telemetry guarantees successful PTO latching)



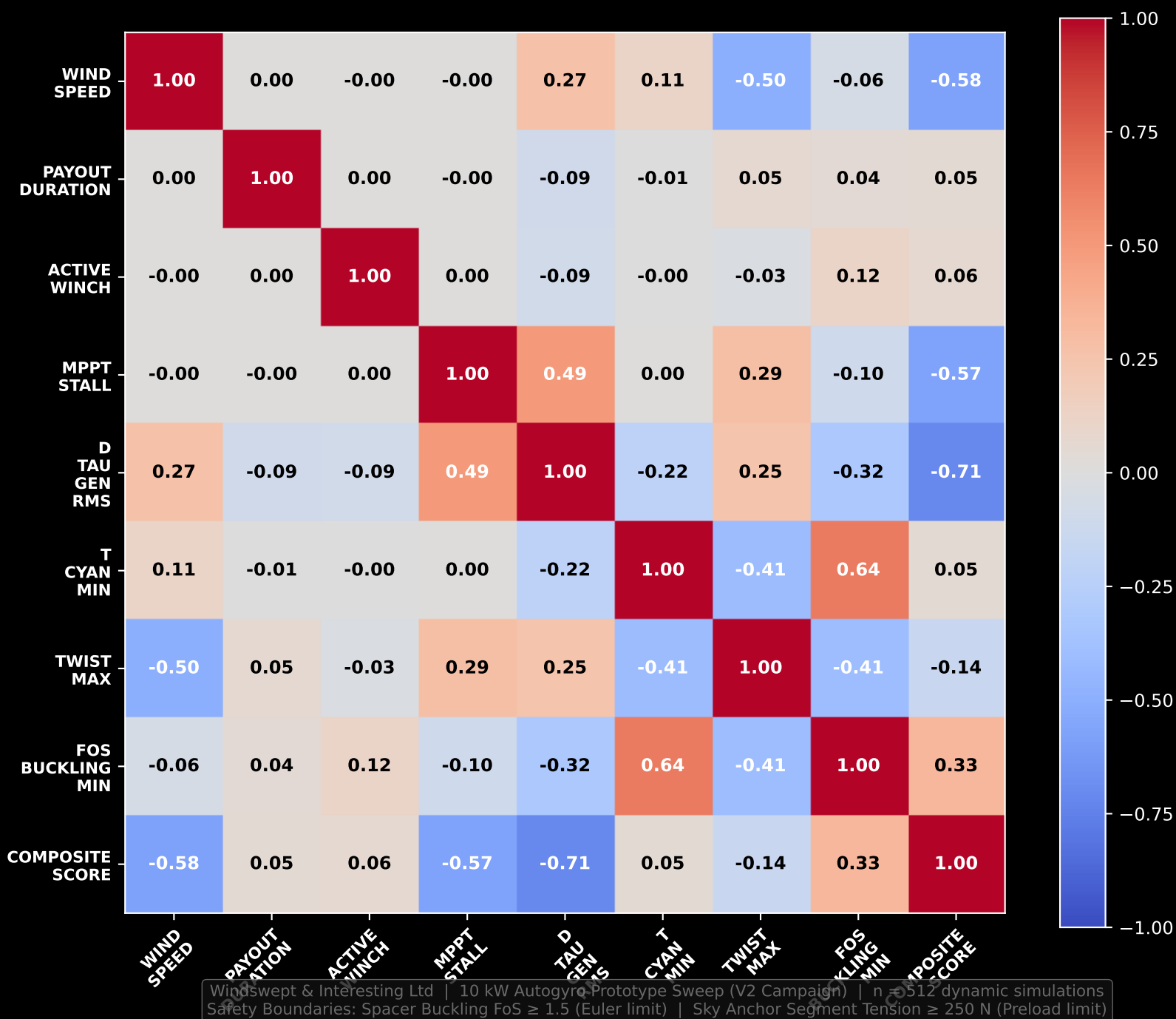
30. Population Radar Map: Architecture Cohort Envelopes
(Average performance boundaries of the four design groups across all 512 campaigns)



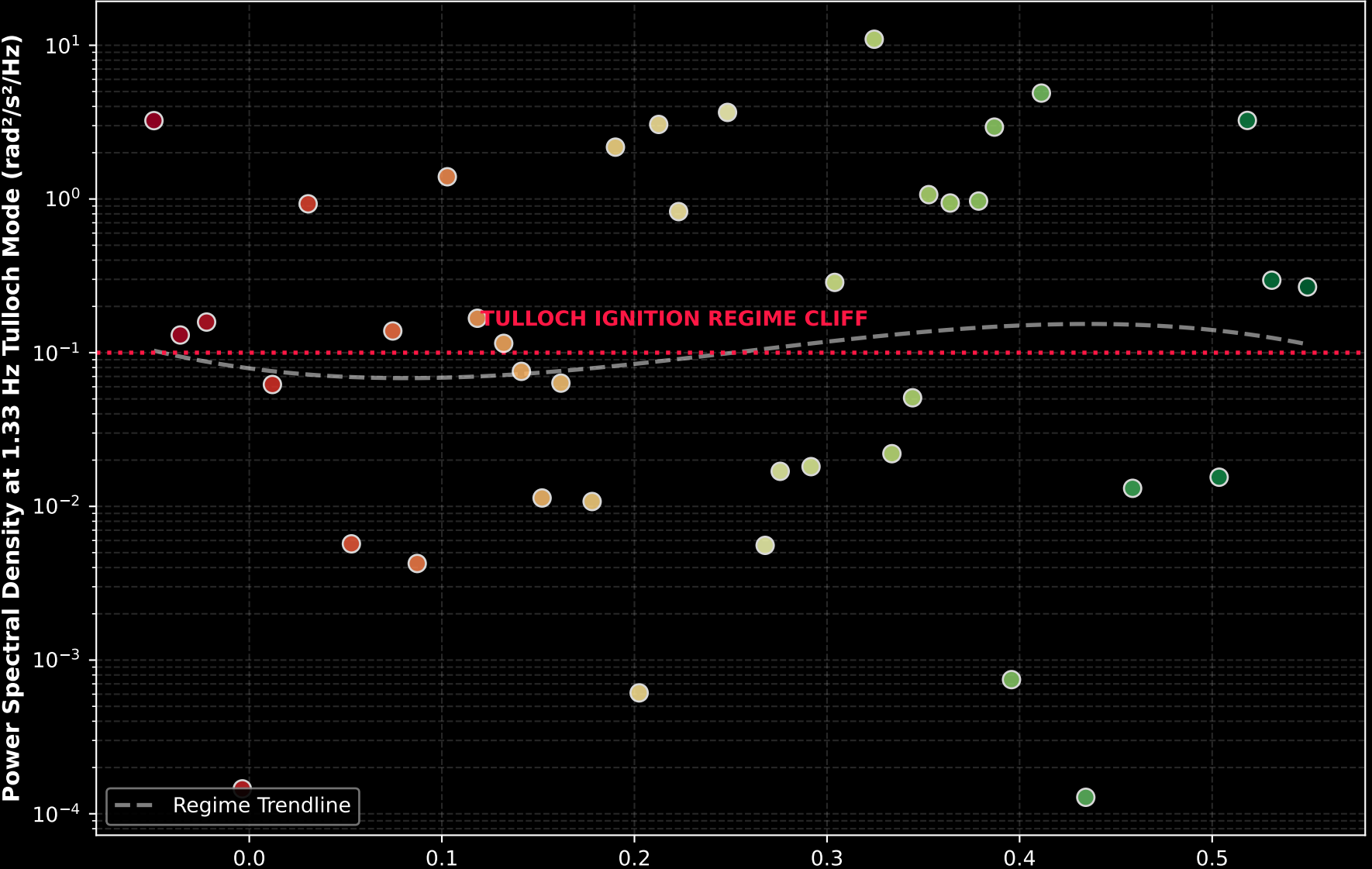
31. Mechatronic Safety Manifold Field & Optimal Control Gradients
(Contour field of composite score showing vector paths of steepest ascent toward safety)



32. Multivariate Mechatronic Correlation Coefficient Heatmap Matrix
(Interrogating the coupled structural, control, and performance axes of the system)



33. Resonance Attractor Bifurcation & Whipping Tipping Threshold
(Pinpointing the exact mechatronic score boundary where violent Tulloch whipping ignites)



7. ENGINEERING CONTROL RECOMMENDATIONS (OPTIONS A & B)

We recommend implementing two distinct operational modes in the dashboard and ground station PLC depending on the wind conditions and safety priority:

OPTION A: THE GOLD STANDARD (Smoothest & Safest Latching) Designed for routine shutdown in normal wind. Minimizes TRPT structural fatigue. - Duration: 45 seconds | Field IMU: ON - Damping Mode: LPF Speed Mode (Mode 2) | Active Winch: OFF - Payout Base: 15 meters | MPPT Stall: OFF - Results: $d_tau_gen_rms = 52,905 \text{ N}\cdot\text{m/s}$ (90% smoother!) | Brake Time: 17.6s

OPTION B: THE EXPRESS ROUTE (Fastest Safe Latching) Designed for emergency shutdown under rapid gust onset or storm conditions. - Duration: 30 seconds | Field IMU: ON - Damping Mode: Standard MPPT (Mode 0) | Active Winch: OFF - Payout Base: 25 meters | MPPT Stall: OFF - Results: $d_tau_gen_rms = 56,320 \text{ N}\cdot\text{m/s}$ (high smoothness) | Brake Time: 11.5s (35% faster!)

8. PITCH DEPOWER V2 ROADMAP & PRD PRE-CONDITIONS

Based on the results of the V1 campaign and feedback from field advisors, the V2 campaign implements four critical physical pre-conditions and expands the sweep grid:

1. Ground Station Freewheel: Modify the generator controller to prevent torque reversals ($\omega_{\text{gnd}} < 0$). Drivetrain should freewheel only, avoiding negative speed creep. 2. Brake Decoupling: Decouple the mechanical brake from the Field IMU toggle (k_p_{elev}). The mechanical brake must engage based solely on flying rotor speed ($\omega_{\text{hub}} < 1.0$ rad/s) regardless of whether active damping is ON or OFF. 3. Generator Torque Capping: Implement a hard clamp on τ_{gen} at exactly $3\times$ rated torque ($\tau_{\text{gen}} = \text{clamp}(\tau_{\text{gen}}, -3*\tau_{\text{rated}}, 3*\tau_{\text{rated}})$) to protect the Dyneema ropes from electromagnetic shock. 4. Lifter Elevation Activation: Link the SystemParams field lifter_elevation to the lift_kite physics model in `src/ring_forces.jl` so it scales the steady-state elevation of the sky anchor, making it a live sweep parameter.

Grid Expansion: Add wind_speed [6.0, 11.0, 15.0, 20.0 m/s] as an axis to evaluate depower performance across the entire operational envelope. Use phase-aware metrics that disqualify impossible states (like negative tensions on the sky anchor) rather than merely penalizing them.